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US bond turmoil signals rising global macro pressures

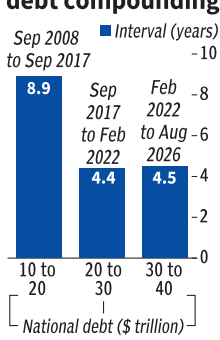
REGIME CHANGE. As bond yields spike across major markets, valuations will matter even more for equity investors; gold's relevance is intact

Nishanth Gopalakrishnan
bl, research bureau

James Carville, lead strategist for former US President Bill Clinton, famously remarked that if reincarnation exists, he would want to come back as the bond market because it can intimidate everybody. History provides ample evidence of this power. Past spikes in bond yields have triggered the bursting of asset bubbles and even ousted world leaders, as seen with former UK Prime Minister Liz Truss. Hence, it would be a mistake to view last week's efforts by US Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent to calm the US government bond market — the world's most liquid market — as routine.

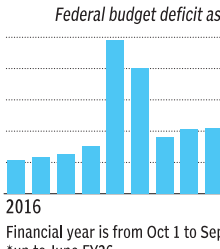
Coinciding with a surge in US' long-term bond yields, with the 30-year yield hitting 5.3 per cent on Monday, its highest since June 2007, or in nearly 19 years, the US Treasury made a surprise announcement last Wednesday on intervention in the bond market. In what some bond market veterans viewed as a sign of panic, it said that, starting September 9, it double its buybacks of 10-20-year and 20-30-year government bonds to provide liquidity support. According to experts, to fund

US national debt compounding



While \$30-40 trillion has taken the same time as \$20-30 trillion, it has come in times when economic growth has been robust

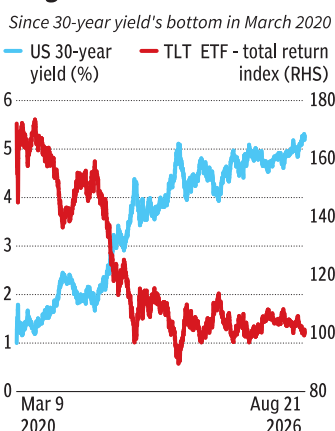
Budget deficit remains elevated



Financial year is from Oct 1 to Sep 30 up to June FY26

Source: US Department of the Treasury, Federal Reserve of St. Louis, Bloomberg

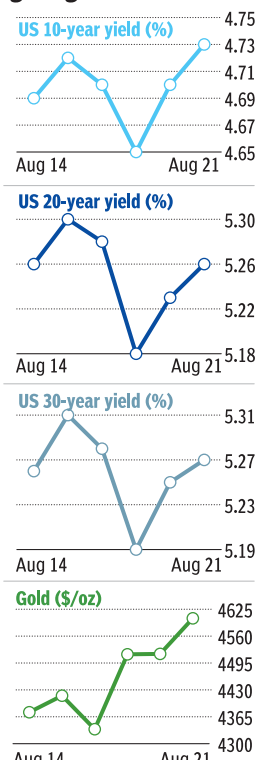
No respite for long-bond investors



Yields have hardened globally

10-year sovereign yields (%)	Jan 1 2020	Current
US	1.92	4.73
Japan	-0.01	2.89
UK	0.82	5.06
Germany	-0.19	3.26
France	0.12	4.13

Bond yields retrace, gold gains



LOSING CONTROL

The 10-year and 30-year bonds which began the week at yields of 4.69 per cent and 5.26 per cent, respectively, initially reacted positively to the Treasury's move by falling to 4.65 per cent and 5.19 per cent by Wednesday. They subsequently reversed course, ending the week at 4.73 per cent and 5.27 per cent — higher than their starting levels.

Gold gained 5.2 per cent during the week as investors sought alternatives to the US dollar and a hedge against inflation (see charts). The pain of bond investors in recent years is captured by the TLT ETF, which invests in government bonds maturing in 20 years or later (see chart). The ever-expanding US national debt, meanwhile, hit the \$40-trillion milestone on Tuesday — just a trillion dollars away from the Congress-set debt ceiling. The federal budget deficit remains elevated at around 6 per cent of GDP, even as the economy continues to show strength (see chart).

Bessent may have downplayed the market intervention as merely a measure to bolster liquidity. But against this backdrop, the bond market's U-turn last week points

to a growing trust deficit in the signalling power of government agencies.

Experts view the Treasury's initiative as a band-aid for a structural problem and as 'buying time' ahead of the mid-term elections. According to Peter Bookvar, CIO at OnePoint BFG Wealth Partners, the buybacks also tie the Fed's hands on interest rates. Raising policy rates to contain inflation could make short-term treasuries cost more — the very ones that the Treasury plans to issue more of to buyback longer dated bonds. On the other hand, if the Fed stands by as prices continue to rise, the long-dated bond yields could go up again and even more as inflation expectations get unanchored.

To top it all, the move by the US Treasury is at odds with what Fed Chair Kevin Warsh has been advocating — letting economic data determine bond prices, reducing the market's reliance on central bank guidance, and ending policies that artificially subsidise government deficits.

WANING CREDIBILITY

Market's paranoia is not without reason. President Trump campaigned on reducing debt and deficit. He set up the Department of Govern-

ment Efficiency (DOGE) under Elon Musk for that objective. He even advocated increasing crude oil production to help lower energy costs.

A year and a half into his term, however, national debt has risen by about \$4 trillion, budget deficits show little sign of meaningful fiscal consolidation, and oil prices are higher. This comes as the US Fed has failed to bring inflation back to its 2 per cent target for 64 consecutive months.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Jeffrey Gundlach, the DoubleLine Capital CEO often referred to as the 'Bond King', recently stated that the US national debt "is no longer your grandchildren's problem. It is our problem." Given that bond yields have been spiking not just in the US but also across other heavily indebted developed economies (see table), there is a growing case that the ample global liquidity that powered equity markets since the global financial crisis may be a thing of the past.

Valuations will begin to matter even more, while the relative attractiveness of equities vs bonds for FIIs will be a dominant factor. Gold, meanwhile, is likely to remain in the spotlight.

INVESTMENT FOCUS

HSBC Equity Savings Fund: Invest

Dhuraivel Gunasekaran
bl, research bureau

Investors with a two- to four-year investment horizon can consider investing in HSBC Equity Savings Fund.

The scheme has received a two-notch upgrade, moving from three to five stars in the latest *bl portfolio* mutual fund star rating.

The upgrade reflects the fund's improved risk-adjusted performance over the past 6-12 months. Over the last seven years, the fund has delivered a compounded annualised return of 11.6 per cent. The fund invests across active equity, arbitrage and debt. Its combined equity and arbitrage exposure is maintained above 65 per cent, allowing it to qualify for equity taxation.

This makes the equity savings fund category attractive to conservative investors seeking potentially better returns than fixed-income investments without taking on the full risk of equity markets.

[Read more](#) P4

Govt makes biometric verification mandatory for issue of SIMs and related services

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

The government has made biometric verification mandatory for the purchase of new mobile SIM cards, updating user details, disconnection and re-verification under the Telecommunications Act, 2023.

The Telecommunications (User Identification) Rules, 2026, were notified by the Department of Telecommunications (DoT) through a Gazette Notification dated August 21.

The Rules apply to the biometric-based identification of users of notified telecom services by authorised entities.

The move follows a DoT notification issued in

September 2025 seeking objections and suggestions from stakeholders.

VERIFYING AADHAAR

The government had proposed mandatory Aadhaar-linked biometric verification for digital/electronic Know Your Customer (D-KYC/e-KYC), amid growing concerns over digital-arrest scams and online fraud.

All telecom service providers will have to implement a Biometric Identity Verification System (BIVS) for SIM issuance through their authorised channels.

Authorised entities will have to clearly inform users about the requirement to provide accurate information to establish their identity during biometric verification. Users will also be

required to comply with the Act and refrain from providing false, incorrect or forged information or documents, suppressing material information or impersonating another person.

They will also be prohibited from reselling, transferring or leasing their telecom connection or SIM card to another user. Violations, including furnishing false particulars, could attract penalties under the Telecommunications Act.

EXISTING CONNECTIONS

Under the new Rules, an authorised entity conducting biometric verification must send an alert to the user specifying the relevant telecom connection or SIM and

seek confirmation that the user had made the request.

If the user responds that he did not make the request, the telecom connection will be suspended pending verification and appropriate action, the notification said.

3-MONTH WINDOW

Authorised entities have been given three months from the date the Rules come into force to put in place the required technical and organisational measures and infrastructure.

The government can extend this period by up to another three months if it finds that authorised entities are not adequately prepared to implement the measures in the public interest.

NRIs rush to FCNR-B deposits as RBI deadline nears; \$65 b already in

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Non-Resident Indians (NRIs) are flocking to Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank) [FCNR-B] deposits to tap returns of 6-7.50 per cent on three- to five-year tenors, with banks mobilising a whopping \$65.397 billion in just 75 days, according to the latest RBI data.

The inflows, between June 8 and August 21, are gathering pace as the RBI advanced the deadline for banks to avail of its concessional swap facility for FCNR-B deposits by a month to August 31. Banks offering leverage to NRI customers also contributed to the inflows.

Banks also raised \$4.860 billion through the Overseas Foreign Currency Borrowing (OFCB) route in the June 8-August 21 period, with a portion of the funds

Swelling kitty

Forex inflows mobilised since June 8, 2026

Outstanding as on	FCNR-B	OFCBs	ECBs	Total
Aug 21	65,397	4,860	2,591	72,848
Aug 13	52,300	2,805	1,741	56,846
July 31	36,725	2,575	1,516	40,816
June 8-July 17	17,406	1,970	1,342	20,718

parked in deposits.

With only nine days left for the RBI facility to close, market experts expect FCNR-B inflows to touch \$80 billion. The facility was introduced to encourage banks mobilise foreign currency deposits and bolster forex flows amid rupee volatility.

RBI FACILITY

The latest data point to an acceleration in inflows. Banks mobilised \$13.097 billion in the eight days ended August 21 compared with \$15.575 billion in the preceding 13 days.

Since the RBI introduced

the special swap facility covering FCNR(B) deposits, external commercial borrowings and OFCBs on June 8, total forex inflows reached \$72.848 billion.

Saumya Kanti Ghosh, Group Chief Economic Advisor, SBI, said the early closure of the facility was perhaps because the target for FCNR(B) mobilisation had been achieved. He estimated FCNR-B collections could total \$85 billion. He also expects the balance of payments to remain in surplus at around \$50 billion, with the Current Account Deficit at about 1 per cent of GDP.

AI 'doctors' 'worrisome'

Avinash Nair
Ahmedabad

An "AI Doctor" exhibit at the IIMA Healthcare Summit in Ahmedabad left Drugs Controller General of India Rajeev Raghuvanshi concerned about AI's rapid expansion in healthcare. He said regulators still lack clarity on whether AI systems fit the definition of medical devices. While AI is already transforming healthcare, Raghuvanshi said the bigger challenge will arise when AI moves beyond supporting doctors and developers to making recommendations directly to consumers.

The DGCI said regulators approve a product based on defined characteristics of quality, safety and performance and expect those characteristics to remain consistent through the product's lifecycle.

[Details](#) P12

1st ANNIVERSARY

*In loving memory of a true legend,
a guiding light, and an eternal inspiration*



Mr. P. S. Ravindran

Director, Vajiram & Ravi

1949 – 2025

*His vision, wisdom, and unwavering dedication
continue to inspire us every day.*

*Fondly remembered by his family, colleagues,
faculty, Staffs and generations of students of
Vajiram & Ravi.*



VAJIRAM & RAVI
Institute for IAS Examination

Kumar Shankar Roy
bl. research bureau

From *Aryabhata* and the PSLV to *Chandrayaan* and *Mangalyaan*, India’s space story was for decades almost synonymous with Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO). That is beginning to change. In July, Skyroot Aerospace’s Vikram-1 became the first privately-developed Indian rocket to reach orbit, while a new crop of companies is building satellites, propulsion systems, imaging technologies and space-data businesses.

On its part, the Government of India has undertaken major reforms to transform the space sector into a private-sector-driven and globally-competitive ecosystem.

Still for the average Indian, space exploration evokes images of rockets, moon/inter-planetary missions and astronauts. Getting something into space is essential, but much of the economic activity happens before and after the launch too.

The global ecosystem includes companies that make rockets and satellites, manufacturers of propulsion systems (generates thrust to push a spacecraft forward), electronics and optics (enables satellite imaging, sensing and observation). Then, there are ground stations that communicate with satellites, satellite broadband providers and businesses that turn images and other data from space into usable information.

Elon Musk’s SpaceX, familiar to investors following its recent mammoth \$86-billion IPO, illustrates how these businesses can connect.

Many of India’s emerging pure-play space-tech companies are still unlisted today, but understanding their business models now can help investors assess them better if and when they enter public markets.

Understanding these differences is essential before treating them all as part of one “space-tech” investment theme.

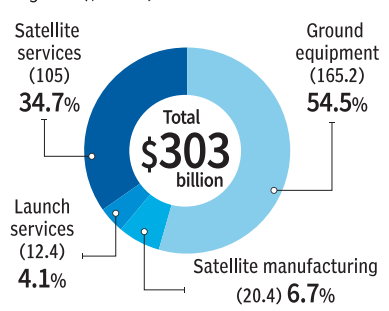
MANY BUSINESSES

Space is the region beyond Earth’s atmosphere where satellites and spacecraft operate. The conventional boundary is around 100 km (62 miles) above Earth’s mean sea-level, the Kármán line.

Think of ‘launch’ as effectively the

Global commercial satellite industry revenue

Segment (\$ billion) % share



Above numbers for 2025
Source: Satellite Industry Association

transportation business of space. Large rockets can carry several customers together through “rideshare”. SpaceX, for instance, charges small satellite operators for space on scheduled launches. This can sharply reduce the cost per kg because many customers share the rocket. For context, a Deutsche Bank Research notes that SpaceX’s rideshare programme starts at about \$350,000 for 50 kg, with additional mass priced at around \$7,000 per kg. A rideshare drop-off may also not be the satellite’s final destination; onboard propulsion or an orbital-transfer vehicle may be required

India’s space-tech in orbit



GETTY IMAGES/STOCKPHOTO

to move it to the desired altitude and orbital plane.

Smaller launchers such as those being developed by Skyroot Aerospace and Agnikul Cosmos offer a different proposition: customers can pay more for dedicated launches with greater control over orbit and timing, much like choosing a taxi over a bus. For costly payloads, proven flight performance can matter more than launch price, while defence missions may value sovereign access and security. Small launchers, therefore, need not beat larger rockets on cost per kg. But launch remains capital-intensive, and technological success does not guarantee attractive returns. SpaceX’s Space segment, for instance, achieved sustained positive adjusted EBITDA only from 2018, around 16 years after its founding.

Satellite manufacturing is a different business. Companies can sell the satellite platform or “bus”, providing structure, power, communications and thermal control for a customer’s payload, or supply complete satellites. Component makers supply propulsion, electronics, antennas, optics, power systems and precision parts. They need not finance entire constellations and can sell qualified subsystems across multiple programmes; switching suppliers can also be difficult once components are designed into a platform. For India, where much listed exposure lies in such “picks-and-shovels”, the opportunity depends on increasing indigenous content, owning more proprietary subsystems, scaling production and winning exports.

Then come communications and data. Satellite communications (satcom) can combine hardware sales, such as terminals or antennas, with recurring connectivity revenue. Beyond households, aircraft, ships, mines, pipelines and farms can use satellite links where terrestrial networks are unavailable or uneconomic. JPMorgan notes that in areas such as maritime, logistics, mining and precision agriculture, coverage rather than sheer network capacity can

be the key constraint. Satcom, however, remains capital-intensive, requiring satellites, launch, terminals, spectrum and ground infrastructure, while satellites also need periodic replacement.

Earth observation uses satellites to monitor the planet, but the greater value can lie in extracting usable information. A bank may want crop-condition data before lending, an insurer a flood-damage assessment, a miner terrain or mineral insights, and defence customers information on changes at specific locations.

The value chain can therefore move from **image** → **processed data** → **analytics** → **intelligence** → **decision**. The same orbital asset can potentially serve multiple customers, while businesses embedded in customer workflows may generate more recurring revenue than raw-imagery providers, provided their data remains differentiated.

Around this core sit ground-station operators providing satellite communication access, space-awareness companies tracking satellites and space debris, and emerging orbital-servicing companies seeking revenue from refuelling, repair and satellite-life extension. See **table 1** on how space-tech businesses make money.

INDIA’S NEWSPACE

India’s private space ecosystem has expanded rapidly since sector reforms began in 2020. The Indian Space Policy 2023 opened end-to-end activities to private participation, IN-SPACe acts as the authorisation and promotion interface, and NSIL commercialises technologies and platforms developed through public expenditure. The government says the ecosystem now has more than 400 start-ups and targets a \$44-billion space economy by 2033, including \$11 billion of exports. The private-sector ecosystem already spans much of the value chain (see **table 2**).

Skyroot crossed an important technological milestone in July when Vikram-1 became India’s first privately-

WISE WORDS.

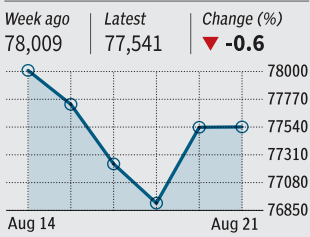
“People who invest make money for themselves; people who speculate make money for their brokers

JASON ZWEIG

Author and journalist

MARKET ACTION.

SENSEX



NIFTY

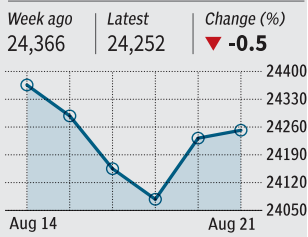


TABLE 1

How they make money

Model	What customer pays for	Revenue nature
Launch	Delivery to orbit	Per launch/per kg
Components	Propulsion, optics, electronics etc.	Per unit/programme
Satellite platform	Satellite bus/complete spacecraft	Project/unit
Satcom	Terminal + connectivity	Hardware + recurring
Earth observation	Imagery/data	Tasking/subscription
Analytics	Answer/decision	Subscription/API/contracts
Ground station	Satellite communication access	Usage/service fee
Space awareness	Tracking/intelligence	Contract/subscription
Orbital servicing	Refuelling/repair/life extension	Mission/service

Source: Industry reports, studies

TABLE 2

Private-sector space ecosystem

Segment	Companies	What they broadly do
Launch	Skyroot Aerospace, Agnikul Cosmos	Develop small launch vehicles for placing satellites and other payloads into orbit
Satellite platforms	Dhruva Space	Satellite platforms, launch integration and ground-station services
Propulsion	Bellatrix Aerospace, Manastu Space	Propulsion systems that manoeuvre satellites and spacecraft in orbit
Earth observation	Pixxel, GalaxEye, PierSight	Satellite-based imaging and sensing for commercial and strategic applications
Data & analytics	SatSure	Converts satellite and other geospatial data into usable insights for sectors such as banking, agriculture and insurance
Space-domain awareness	Digantara	Tracks satellites and other objects in orbit and provides related monitoring/intelligence
Orbital servicing	OrbitAID, Inspecity	Developing refuelling, servicing and life-extension solutions for satellites

Company roles above are based on public disclosures and our understanding of an evolving sector, where some strategic projects may not be fully disclosed

LISTED PLAYS

Here lies an important limitation for Indian investors. Most of the country’s prominent pure-play space businesses remain unlisted. There is no direct listed equivalent today of Skyroot, Pixxel or Digantara. Listed exposure is concentrated mainly in companies supplying different parts of the space ecosystem (see **table 3**). These include Astra Microwave, Data Patterns, Paras Defence, MTAR Technologies, Avantel, BEL, HAL, L&T, Mishra Dhatu and BHEL.

Globally, investors have access to a wider set of listed space businesses spanning launch, satellite data, connectivity and other emerging segments (see **table 4**). They include the likes of SpaceX, Rocket Lab, AST SpaceMobile, Intuitive Machines, Virgin Galactic, Planet Labs, BlackSky Technology, Spire Global, Lockheed Martin, Northrop Grumman and L3Harris Technologies. The last three are diversified defence/aerospace groups.

Large conglomerates such as Tata, Reliance and Adani also have space exposure, though it remains indirect and small relative to their overall businesses. For bigger firms, space growth may not materially impact consolidated earnings. Genuine space capabilities do not necessarily make a company a meaningful “space stock”.

Also, investors should understand what can go wrong in ‘space-tech stocks’ in the Indian market context.

***Technology risk:** One failed mission can set a young launcher back materially.

***Qualification risk:** Flight heritage matters; customers may resist unproven systems.

***Capital intensity:** Rockets and constellations require funding before meaningful scale.

***Customer concentration:** Government/ISRO may dominate early demand.

***Regulation:** Launch approvals, spectrum, remote-sensing rules, export controls.

***Demand risk:** Capacity does not cre-

What to track

Launch
Successful flights, launch frequency, order book, cost per launch, reuse

Components
Space revenue share, intellectual property, qualification, export orders

Satellite maker
Order book, standardisation, production capacity, customer mix

EO/data
Satellites operational, imaging frequency, contracted customers, recurring revenue

Satcom
Terminals/users, average revenue per user, utilisation, recurring-service mix

Space awareness
Sensor network, coverage, government contracts, recurring data revenues

ate customers automatically.

***Obsolescence:** Fast-moving satellite/component technology can shorten economic lives.

***Valuation risk:** Thematic expectations may run ahead of actual space revenues.

LOOK BEYOND THE THEME

For investors, the first question is whether space is material to a company’s business. How much of its revenue, order book or future growth actually comes from the sector?

The next is what it owns. A company manufacturing a customer’s design occupies a different position from one owning proprietary technology, a qualified subsystem or an integrated platform, which can potentially capture more value across multiple programmes. Revenue quality also varies. Component makers earn when another unit is ordered, while communications, data or intelligence businesses may generate recurring revenue from the same infrastructure or customer relationship.

Investors should also resist applying the size of the entire space economy to every company associated with it. SpaceX’s IPO prospectus, for instance, cited a TAM of about \$28.5 trillion across space, connectivity and AI-related opportunities. Industry opportunity, addressable market and the revenue an individual company can realistically capture are very different things.

India’s emerging space economy is broader than a rocket story. Listed investors today largely access it through “picks and shovels”. As the ecosystem matures, that could change. Investors need to understand where each company sits in the chain, what it sells, who pays for it and whether sector growth can actually translate into revenues and profits. In conclusion, one thing is clear: The industry has achieved escape velocity and is well on its voyage to become a meaningful part of the investing ecosystem. Investors would do well to take cognisance of that shift.

TABLE 3

India’s listed space exposure

Company	Space-related capabilities/exposure	P/E (trailing)	EV/ EBITDA (trailing)	3-year revenue growth (CAGR %)	3-year PAT growth (CAGR %)	Latest M-cap (₹ cr)
Astra Microwave Products	RF and microwave systems for defence and space; proposed separation of space, meteorology and hydrology businesses into Astra Space Technologies	79.2	47.4	12.6	40.4	15,788
Data Patterns	Satellite electronics, onboard computers, satellite platforms and ground systems	99.6	71.2	26.8	28.7	27,020
Paras Defence & Space Technologies	Space optics including large optics, mirrors and diffractive gratings used in imaging applications	137.2	99.6	28.9	33.6	12,096
MTAR Technologies	Precision components and assemblies for liquid propulsion and cryogenic engines, including turbopumps	230	128	15.9	-3	21,636
Avantel	Satellite-communication products; developing Ground Segment as a Service infrastructure	291.3	89.4	13	-17.1	4,258
Bharat Electronics	Satellite ground communications, space-grade electronics; satellite assembly/integration/testing capabilities	49.3	36.5	15.5	26.8	3,02,259
HAL	Structures and other hardware for India’s space programme	35.8	29.5	7.2	13.6	3,33,585
L&T	Launch-vehicle structures and space hardware	33.9	21.5	16.1	15.7	5,62,461
Mishra Dhatu Nigam	Specialised alloys/materials used in space applications	60.4	34.3	12.5	-5.6	7,939
BHEL	Batteries and other equipment for space applications	89.8	59.8	13.5	35.9	1,43,600

Revenue and PAT are on adjusted basis. Company roles and capabilities discussed here are based on public disclosures and our understanding of the evolving ecosystem, where some strategic projects may not be fully disclosed. Note: These are not stock recommendations. Source: Bloomberg, BSE, broker reports, industry reports

TABLE 4

Global space stocks at a glance

Company	Space-related capabilities/exposure	Annual revenue (\$ million)	Annual EBITDA (\$ million)	Latest M-cap (\$ billion)
Space Exploration (SpaceX)	Launch, satellites and satellite connectivity	18,674	4,799	1,825
Rocket Lab Corp.	Launch, spacecraft and satellite components	602	-160	46.2
AST SpaceMobile	Direct-to-smartphone satellite broadband	71	-229	25.9
Intuitive Machines	Lunar missions and space infrastructure	210	-79	4.2
Virgin Galactic	Commercial human spaceflight	1.5	-253	0.5
Planet Labs*	Earth observation and satellite imagery	308	-32	7.9
BlackSky Technology	Earth observation and geospatial intelligence	107	-12	1.1
Spire Global	Satellite data and analytics	72	-45	0.6
Lockheed Martin	Satellites and national-security space systems	75,048	8,224	131.3
Northrop Grumman	Satellites, propulsion and space systems	41,954	6,115	79
L3Harris Technologies	Space sensors, payloads and satellite systems	21,865	4,105	50.1

* Pertains to 2026, all other companies are for 2025. Revenue and EBITDA numbers are on adjusted basis. Many of the smaller companies are loss-making at PAT level.

Note: These are not stock recommendations. Source: Bloomberg

Equity upside with a safety cushion

FUND CALL. HSBC Equity Savings Fund suits cautious investors seeking lower volatility, tax efficiency and a two-four-year horizon

Dhuraivel Gunasekaran
bl. research bureau

HSBC Equity Savings Fund (HESF) has received a two-notch upgrade, moving from three stars to five stars in the latest *bl.portfolio* mutual fund star rating. The upgrade reflects the fund's improved risk-adjusted performance over the past 6-12 months. Over the last seven years, the fund has delivered a compounded annualised return of 11.6 per cent. Cautious investors seeking relatively-lower drawdowns and with a two- to four-year investment horizon can consider the fund.

FUND CATEGORY
Equity savings funds can offer a tax-efficient investment option for investors with a low to moderate risk appetite. They seek to deliver returns higher-than-conventional fixed income

products while limiting the volatility associated with pure equity investments. These hybrid funds typically invest across active equity, arbitrage and debt. The combination of equity and arbitrage exposure is maintained above 65 per cent, allowing them to qualify for equity taxation. This makes the category attractive to conservative investors seeking potentially-better returns than fixed income without taking on the full risk of equity markets.

HESF follows a conservative debt portfolio construction approach combined with selective equity alpha generation. The fund has the flexibility to allocate 15-40 per cent to active equity, while equity plus arbitrage exposure is maintained at a minimum of 65 per cent to qualify for equity taxation. The balance is invested in debt. Broadly, the fund follows a one-third allocation each to active equity,

PORTFOLIO SIGNALS

- Five-star upgrade reflects better risk-adjusted performance
- Equity sleeve drives most return alpha
- Debt strategy prioritises preservation over alpha



arbitrage and debt, although the proportions can vary depending on market opportunities and the fund manager's conviction.

EQUITY STRATEGY
The principal source of alpha is the active equity portfolio, where the fund follows a bottom-up, high-conviction approach. Equity allocation has generally remained in the 30-36 per cent range. The portfolio is constructed across large-, mid-and small-cap stocks, with a major allocation to large- and mid-cap companies.

The fund prefers companies with sustainable growth prospects, sound capital allocation and strong corporate governance. It examines the profit-and-loss statement, including EBITDA margins, to assess pricing power and the ability to pass on cost pressures to customers. Balance-sheet strength and cash-flow generation are also important indicators of business health, with particular attention paid to working capital ratios. Valuation is considered towards the end of the process, primarily using relative P/E and EV/EBITDA measures.

Three broad themes currently stand out in the fund's equity strategy. The first is fin-

ancials, particularly financial penetration and capital markets. The second is manufacturing, supported by government initiatives such as Atmanirbhar Bharat, Production Linked Incentive schemes, and policies covering semiconductors and electronics. The third is domestic discretionary consumption.

ARBITRAGE
The arbitrage team independently identifies opportunities arising from spreads between the cash and derivatives markets and takes positions based on available monthly spreads. The arbitrage manager does not consider stocks held by the equity team while constructing the arbitrage portfolio.

DEBT STRATEGY
The debt portfolio is managed with a clear focus on capital preservation and income genera-

tion rather than alpha generation. Over the last five years, the fund has invested only in government securities and AAA-rated corporate bonds, thereby avoiding credit risk and limiting exposure to significant duration risk.

Most debt investments have a maturity profile of around one to two years.

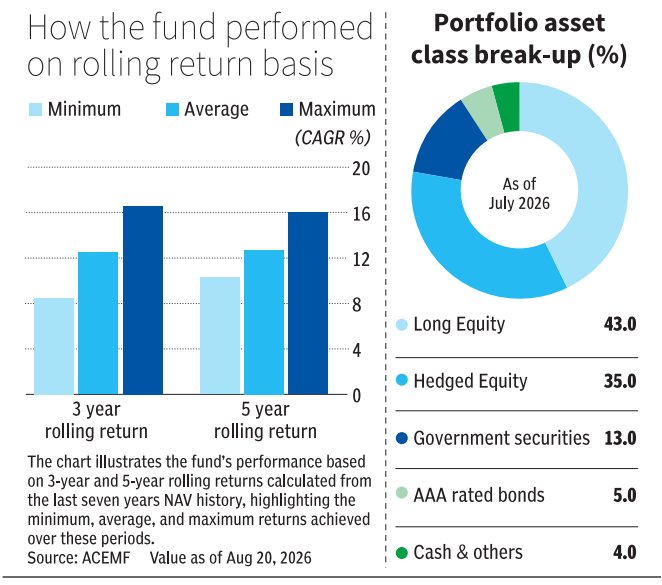
The fund therefore does not seek to generate additional returns through aggressive calls on either credit quality or interest-rate duration. Its Macaulay duration has ranged between 1.9 and 3.3 years. Major corporate bond holdings include issuers such as Reliance Industries, NABARD and Small Industries Development Bank of India.

PERFORMANCE
The fund's performance has been consistent on a rolling-return basis. Over the past seven years, its five-year rolling returns averaged 12.7 per cent CAGR, compared with 9.7 per cent for the category. During this period, five-year returns ranged between 10.3 per cent and 16 per cent.

On a three-year rolling-return basis, the fund delivered a 12.5 per cent CAGR, compared with 9.6 per cent for the category average.

The regular plan carries an expense ratio of 1.29 per cent, lower than the category average of 1.48 per cent. The direct plan's expense ratio is 0.57 per cent, compared with 0.62 per cent for the category.

Overall, the fund can be considered by conservative investors looking for a relatively stable hybrid allocation over a two- to four-year period.



Jackson Hole, a bigger risk than Nvidia

GLOBAL VIEW. Earnings from the AI bellwether and the economic symposium loom large in Wall Street's thinking next week

Bloomberg

Allspring Global Investments' Ann Miletti said Wall Street has more to worry about from next week's Jackson Hole economic symposium than earnings from AI bellwether Nvidia Corp.

"The thing that we try to stay focused on with all the craziness going on is what you can control," said Miletti, who is Allspring's head of equity investments. "Looking at companies from a bottom-up perspective, really understanding what companies have the balance sheet and the flexibility to kind of get through any environment — that's really where we're focused, and that's what we have control of."

Investors should keep expectations low heading into the Jackson Hole event, Miletti said. That forum — hosted by the Federal Reserve Bank of Kansas City and headlined by Fed Chairman Kevin Warsh on August 28 — comes two days after quarterly results from Nvidia, whose \$5.2-trillion market value makes it the world's most-valuable public company.

Nvidia and Jackson Hole both loom large in Wall Street's thinking next week. But there may be greater uncertainty

● INFLATION CONCERNS

There may be greater uncertainty around the Fed event, because Treasury yields have jumped since last month's policy meeting

That concern is amplified by turbulence in bonds, with 30-year Treasury yields spiking to more than 5.3 per cent this week before Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent's decision to double a planned debt buyback to \$4 billion.

That shock intervention briefly stirred market optimism but failed to deliver lasting relief.

On equities, Miletti said she would "not mind a little bit more" correction following the pullback seen in July, arguing it would put markets "in a better place to really remain stable for the rest of the year."

Healthcare and small-cap industrials are her preferred areas, she said.

While healthcare stocks have underperformed, a rotation is starting to take shape as investors see AI-driven innovation potential, she said.

CORPORATE BORROWING

Miletti said corporate borrowing costs have moved from below 5 per cent at the start of the year to above 5.5 per cent.

While the absolute level is not historically extreme, "it's the quickness of the move, the sharpness of the move that can make a difference" — particularly given the scale of capital expenditure spending underway, said Miletti, who is also Allspring's chief diversity officer.

ALERTS.

ICICI Pru Value Fund completes 22 years

ICICI Prudential Value Fund, an open-ended equity scheme following a value investment strategy, has completed 22 years since its launch. The scheme is the largest



actively-managed value-oriented equity fund in the Indian mutual fund industry in terms of assets under management (AUM) at ₹61,102.29 crore and accounts for nearly 28 per cent of the total AUM in the value category. The fund was launched on August 16, 2004. A lump-sum investment of ₹1 lakh made at inception, as of July 31, 2026,

would have grown to ₹46.6 lakh, a CAGR of 19.11 per cent. A comparable investment in the Nifty 50 TRI would have grown to ₹20.1 lakh, a CAGR of 14.63 per cent, over the same period.

Resumption of subscription in Tata Gold ETF, Tata Gold ETF FOF

Tata Mutual Fund has resumed subscriptions by large investors in Tata Gold ETF and removed the investment limit on lumpsum purchases and switch-ins into Tata Gold



ETF Fund of Fund, effective August 21. Earlier, effective June 8, direct subscriptions by investors putting in at least ₹25 crore in Tata Gold ETF had been temporarily restricted. Lump-sum purchases and switch-ins into Tata Gold ETF FOF were also capped at ₹10 lakh per PAN per calendar

month for transactions received after the cut-off time on June 8.

ETF movers

Top ETFs (Exchange Traded Funds) traded on NSE based on weekly change in price

	NAV (₹) as on Aug 21	Price (₹)	Weekly change in price (%)	Volume traded in the last week (in '000s)
ETF				
Kotak Silver ETF	23.6	23.7	5.5	24,634
Mirae Asset Silver ETF	236.6	237.3	5.5	1,249
Bandhan Silver ETF	243.4	244.1	5.4	123
Edelweiss Silver ETF	242.7	243.7	5.4	1,129
Nippon India Silver ETF	232.5	232.9	5.3	117,839
Zerodha Silver ETF	24.7	24.7	5.3	40,951
Tata Silver ETF	23.6	23.6	5.2	230,503
GOLD ETFs				
Invesco India Gold ETF	138.2	138.5	5.4	93
Kotak Gold ETF	132.6	132.9	5.2	9,622
DSP Gold ETF	154.3	154.6	5.1	5,147

Source: Bloomberg. Returns as on August 21, 2026

Best NPS plans

Top pension funds in each category based on 5-year CAGR					
Name of the fund	NAV (₹) as on Aug 21	Returns (% CAGR)			Assets (₹ cr)
		3-year	5-year	10-year	
TIER I: EQUITY PLANS					
HDFC Pension Fund	54.8	11.5	10.9	12.8	83,530
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	75.4	12.5	11.9	12.7	31,712
Kotak Pension Fund	68.6	11.8	11.7	12.6	4,858
TIER I: GOVERNMENT BOND PLANS					
LIC Pension Fund	31.6	7.2	6.5	7.8	9,264
SBI Pension Fund	42.3	7.1	6.4	7.3	31,312
HDFC Pension Fund	29.0	6.8	6.1	7.2	56,674
TIER I: CORPORATE DEBT PLANS					
HDFC Pension Fund	30.8	7.9	6.9	8.0	36,261
SBI Pension Fund	46.6	7.8	6.7	7.7	16,480
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	46.4	7.7	6.7	7.7	14,635
TIER II: EQUITY PLANS					
HDFC Pension Fund	47.6	11.7	11.0	12.9	1,921
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	59.6	12.2	11.9	12.7	852
Kotak Pension Fund	60.4	11.8	11.7	12.5	233

*Source: Value Research. Returns as on August 21, 2026

Top PMS schemes

Based on 5-year returns						
AMC	Strategy	AUM (in ₹ cr)	Returns (% CAGR)			
			1-year	3-year	5-year	
LARGE CAP						
Tulsian PMS	Tulsian PMS	364	14.9	20.6	24.1	
Asit C Mehta Invest. Intermediates	ACE Bluechip	5	8.7	17.9	16.8	
ICICI Pru	Largecap	905	7.5	17.6	15.5	
Ksma Wealth	Alpha	16	6.3	12.5	13.8	
MULTI CAP						
New Berry Capitals	Seeking Alpha	9	14.9	17.5	32.9	
Stallion Asset	Core Fund	8,686	15.3	33.8	24.0	
Asit C Mehta Invest. Intermediates	ACE - Multicap	121	10.2	24.3	23.4	
Samvitti Capital	PMS Active Alpha Multicap	483	8.3	20.6	22.2	
Systematix Shares And Stock (I)	Dynamic Investment	NA	18.2	23.6	20.4	
ICICI Pru	Value Strategy	1,180	10.6	18.2	20.1	
MID-CAP						
Right Horizons	Super Value	NA	12.2	14.0	17.1	
Sundaram Alternate Assets	Self Portfolio	NA	35.6	21.9	15.5	
Nippon Life India	Emerging India	NA	9.8	16.3	15.1	
NAFA Asset Managers	Emerging Bluechip	NA	-4.4	11.3	14.9	
SMALL CAP						
Aequitas Invest. Consultancy	India Opportunities	2,319	30.1	28.5	29.6	
Counter Cyclical Investments	Diversified Long Term Value	1,026	4.0	20.0	28.2	
Equitree Capital Advisors	Emerging Opportunities	1,533	-4.5	22.0	21.1	
Green Portfolio	Super 30 Dynamic Fund	248	16.8	19.0	20.1	

*Source: PMS Bazaar. Returns as on July 31, 2026

Symbiotic engines of growth

IPO WATCH. Strong R&D capabilities, integrated operating model and plant expansions augur well for Symbiotec Pharmalab

Sai Prabhakar Yadavalli
bl. research bureau

Symbiotec Pharmalab is a bio-pharmaceutical company with a leading position in fermentation-based hormone and steroid APIs. Its IPO is scheduled for August 24-27. At the upper end of the price band, the issue is valued at 57.8 times FY26 EPS. While this is a premium valuation, it is supported by several long-term growth drivers: steady expansion in the core API business, CDMO opportunities, complex injectables, and insulin and GLP-1 manufacturing.

Strong R&D capabilities, which act as a moat, and an expanded asset base have helped Symbiotec build a fully-integrated operating model from raw materials to drug-device combinations. This positions the company to benefit from rising demand for established biopharma products and bio-manufacturing opportunities. Investors with a three- to five-year perspective can consider subscribing to the IPO given the opportunities developed in CDMO, injectables and GLP-1 fields and scope for earnings growth over the next three-five years as the facilities ramp up. Here, we would like to bring to attention of investors that the company had issued shares in a rights issue in December 2025 at a price of ₹276 per share (compared to IPO price of ₹938-988) which was largely subscribed by the promoters and promoter group. Rights issues in general are priced at a discount to prevailing valuation though.

The IPO consists of a fresh issue of ₹150 crore (debt repayment of ₹112 crore) and an OFS portion of ₹1,607 crore, of which the promoter group accounts for ₹144 crore and the remaining from invested funds (Rosewood Investments and India Business Excellence).

STRONG R&D BASE

The company's capabilities span three complementary segments: Organic chemistry, biotechnology and fermentation and forward integration into complex injectables with double-chamber devices. Corticosteroids and steroidal hormones require an integrated approach that combines organic chemistry with fermentation, where microorgan-



Source: Company website

isms are cultivated under controlled conditions to biosynthesise the active compound. The company's complex product basket should further benefit from its delivery technology platform of double-chamber bags, vials and syringes, which is currently under development.

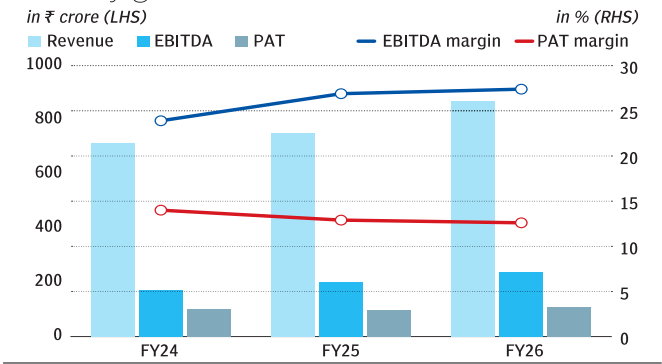
The company has a portfolio of over 60 APIs with leading presence in Corticosteroids (global market share of 38.2 per cent by API volume in FY26) and steroidal hormones (23.8 per cent share), which address severe inflammation, immunological conditions and hormone-based treatments.

GROWTH DRIVERS

The base business, based on API sales, is still growing and has further potential. The leading share of Symbiotec, in a complex portfolio, allows the company to benefit from two factors — supply chain diversification away from China (which is the leader in fermentation-based production) and gaining share from Europe- and the US-based manufacturers. The company can target expanding market share in existing clients and add new clients as well and sustain the 10 per cent revenue CAGR in FY24-26.

It is expanding into CDMO operations based on its established credentials in biotechnology with a commissioned capacity of 400 kilo litres (kl) fermentation capacity. Along with the 300-kl capacity for the base business, the company now has a total of 700-kl fermentation capacity. It has entered into take or pay contracts for long periods of 5-10 years for a significant part of the CDMO ca-

Steady growth



capacity. This includes a 10-year supply agreement for alternate protein in non-pharma CDMO service and another 10-year arrangement for fermentation-based APIs. The CDMO segment should start revenue contribution from late FY27 after completing approvals and accreditations with significant revenue ramp-up expected from FY28.

With notable capability in fermentation, the company is exploring insulin and GLP-1 segments as well. It has commissioned a 14-kl fermentation capacity to manufacture recombinant insulins for domestic companies. The bio-equivalence studies should be completed by FY27 and revenue contributions expected thereon. The company is also poised to start recombinant GLP-1 manufacturing as well for domestic markets and is awaiting approval from the DCGI to shift from China-based chemical synthesis supplies to recombinant method.

It has also commissioned an injectable facility with a capacity of 20 million injectables. But more

importantly, it has developed a value-added delivery platform — double chamber vial DCVs, which are used for controlled release of the drug for improved effectiveness. Two products in its portfolio (Methylprednisolone Sodium Succinate and Hydrocortisone Sodium Succinate) are undergoing studies with expected DCV formulation launch in FY27-28. Parallely, three other products from its API portfolio are also under development for DCV-based formulation launch. With a basket of API produced in-house, as the company establishes a differentiated delivery platform in DCVs (syringe and bags also in development), the company can market its own formulations in regulated markets stepping up from API markets. It has partnered with a US-based leading company in injectables for marketing under a 50-50 profit share agreement, which also includes significant milestone payments for developing and achieving regulatory steps for the portfolio.

The three facilities to be used

A bankable story, fairly valued

BANKING. Having gone through a full cycle of interest rate transmission, SBI's NIM is expected to be stable going forward

Nishanth Gopalakrishnan
bl. research bureau

We had recommended investors to buy the stock of State Bank of India (SBI), when the stock was trading at ₹805 last August. Since then, the stock has given returns of about 30 per cent. Compared with Q1 FY26 (latest quarter when we gave our last call), business has gathered momentum from the second half of FY26, and the net interest margin (NIM) is expected to be stable going forward, now that the bank has largely gone through a full cycle of interest rate transmission.

The stock now trades at a price-to-book value multiple of 1.6x on a consolidated basis. Based on our sum-of-the-parts (SOTP) valuation, which uses trailing metrics, there is not a lot of hidden value to be discovered. However, stock appreciation can follow book value accretion, which in turn chiefly depends on earnings growth. With the management guiding for a credit growth of 14-15 per cent, NIM of 3 per cent and an RoA (return on assets) of 1 per cent for FY27, in our view, the 1.5x multiple assigned to the standalone banking business seems justified. Hence, investors holding the stock can continue to do so.

Here, we look back at how the bank has performed since our earlier call.

CREDIT GROWTH

Retail, agri, SME, corporate and overseas advances make 35, 9, 13, 28 and 15 per cent of SBI's loan book respectively.

Back in Q1 FY26, SBI's loan book grew at an ordinary 11.6 per cent, broadly in alignment with the slowing system level growth of 9.5 per cent. Within the loan book, corporate advances were a laggard which grew a mere 5.7 per cent. However, with GST rate rationalisation, tables turned in the second half of FY26. Credit demand picked up and SBI posted a loan growth of 16.9 per cent for FY26. The momentum continued



SOTP valuation of SBI

Business		Valuation methodology	Per share value in ₹
SBI (standalone banking business)		1.5x current book value	902
Listed	SBI Cards & Payment Services	Market value of SBI's stake at 20% holding company discount	37
	SBI Life Insurance Company		86
	SBI Funds Management		54
	Yes Bank		7
Unlisted	SBI Capital Markets Group	*20x TTM PAT	31
	SBI General Insurance	*2x book value	8
Total			1,125

#Based on the P/B multiples of key listed peers

*Based on the P/E multiples of key listed peers

in Q1 FY27, with a credit growth of 18.6 per cent (on a low base of Q1 FY26) and deposits growing by 9.7 per cent. Both the loan book and deposit book reached respective milestones of ₹50 lakh crore and ₹60 lakh crore. Though deposit growth trailed loan growth, SBI's surplus SLR (statutory liquidity ratio) reserves of about ₹4 lakh crore (as of Q1 FY27) enable higher credit growth.

Corporate advances growth recovered to 14.8 per cent in FY26 and 18 per cent in Q1 FY27. In the latter half of FY26, the bank had started offering corporate loans whose interest rates were based on T-bill yields rather than the typical MCLR-based (marginal cost of lending rate – based on the bank's cost of funds)

loans. These found traction with corporates who had moved on to the bond market from banks to take advantage of better yields there. However, as the move proved unfavourable, the bank has now fallen back to negotiating such loans disbursed, back to being priced on MCLR basis. This meant the corporate book remained flat as of Q1 FY27 vs Q4 FY26, as some corporates have moved on to alternatives. Management has indicated that in most cases, the renegotiation has been completed while for the rest, it is work in progress. When this is done, it could improve margin. For growth though, the bank is upbeat about good corporate credit demand particularly in segments such as data centres, energy storage and M&A

HOLD

State Bank of India
₹1045.40

WHY

- Healthy loan growth ahead
- NIM to stabilise
- No asset quality concerns

deals. It has a sanction pipeline of ₹9 lakh crore. Investors need to watch this segment, going ahead.

SBI's personal loan product (7.4 per cent of loan book) was another laggard that we had pointed out in our last call. It had remained flat in Q1 FY26 as it had in FY25. However, it has found traction now, growing 7.4 per cent in FY26 and 8.3 per cent in Q1 FY26. SBI plans to set up a 6,000-strong 'feet on the street' collection mechanism to expand the product beyond its largely salaried customer base to target self-employed individuals and professionals.

OTHER METRICS

SBI's standalone net profit grew 12.9 per cent in FY26 to a record high of ₹80,032 crore. Profit before tax excluding the Yes Bank stake sale grew 5.9 per cent. Cost-to-income ratio improved to 50.1 per cent for FY26 versus 51.6 per

IPO rating

Symbiotec Pharmalab

Business	★★★★☆
Financials	★★★★☆
Management	★★★★☆
Valuation	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆

Rankings 1 to 5, 1 denoting lowest and 5 highest

Offer period	August 24-27, 2026
Price band	₹938-988
Market cap	₹6,029-6,351 cr

for CDMO, insulin/GLP-1 and injectables have been developed at ₹480 crore, ₹130 crore and ₹400 crore respectively. At peak utilisation in two-three years, the company should generate revenue in line with current asset turnover ratio of 1.5-2 times. Assuming a reasonable probability of execution, the assets should generate significant revenues in comparison to the FY26 revenues of ₹869 crore.

Apart from the above, the company's generic application for Premarin API (conjugated equine estrogens), derived from pregnant mares, is under evaluation. The product has innovator sales of \$1 billion in the US for hormone replacement therapy, despite more than 15 years of losing patent protection. Owing to complexity in manufacturing and proving equivalence, the product has no generics. Symbiotic API under evaluation can be a large gain only if the approval goes through.

FINANCIALS

EBITDA margin for last three years has averaged around 26 per cent. This has been aided by significant backward integration for its fermentation portfolio. It is backward integrated for 80 per cent of the portfolio replacing Chinese imports. This recent development also enables the company to participate significantly in the upcoming PLI scheme for domestic bio-pharmaceutical value chain production incentives. The company reported revenue/EBITDA/PAT of ₹869/₹238/₹109 crore in FY26.

Its debt is from the recently-commissioned facilities and stands at ₹377 crore of net debt (1.6 times EBITDA). The fresh issue proceeds can improve the debt metrics further.

cent for FY25. However, as the bank transmitted multiple rate cuts to borrowers and depositors, NIM (for domestic business; domestic business accounts for 85 per cent of gross advances) declined to 3 per cent for FY26 from 3.2 per cent for FY25 — primarily the cause for modest profit growth. Standalone RoE and RoA came in at a strong 18.6 per cent and 1.1 per cent respectively for FY26. Consolidated earnings grew 7.4 per cent.

In Q1 FY27, NIM remained stable at 3 per cent and the standalone bank reported a profit growth of 10.2 per cent. Annualised RoE and RoA stood at 17.8 per cent and 1.1 per cent. Consolidated earnings grew 13.7 per cent.

Asset quality is at the best level in two decades. Gross and net NPA ratios are at 1.47 per cent and 0.38 per cent. Credit cost and slippage ratio at 0.27 per cent (0.37 per cent in FY26) and 0.57 per cent (0.54 per cent in FY26) do not indicate asset quality pressures. The bank also has ₹29,713 crore of standard asset provisions (as of FY26) amounting to 0.6 per cent of gross advances, as a buffer. Liquidity coverage ratio (amount of highly liquid assets kept to meet cash outflows during a 30-day stress scenario) is adequate at 126 per cent and capital adequacy ratio stands at a healthy 15.6 per cent, boosted by the recent ₹25,000-crore QIP. The Yes Bank stake sale and the SBI Funds Management IPO.

The management has guided for a credit growth of 14-15 per cent for FY27, slightly up from 13-15 per cent as guided at the end of FY26. NIM and RoA (standalone) are expected to be maintained at 3 per cent and 1 per cent respectively, for the current fiscal. Credit cost is likely to be at 0.5 per cent. The management is expected to give an outlook on the impact of the upcoming (from FY28) expected credit loss framework for recognising bad loan provisions in the earnings call for Q2 FY27. This should be a key monitorable for investors.

businessline's editorial policy prohibits analysts from taking positions in the stocks they recommend — **Editor**

Sensex ups & downs

	Price ₹		Movement	% change
	Aug 14	Aug 21		
Eternal	318.0	327.6	▲	3.0
Kotak Mahindra Bank	393.0	402.8	▲	2.5
Axis Bank	1,217.4	1,246.3	▲	2.4
Power Grid	266.5	272.3	▲	2.2
Bharat Electronics	410.4	413.5	▲	0.8
L&T	4,062.7	4,088.1	▲	0.6
Bajaj Finance	1,087.7	1,093.2	▲	0.5
Reliance Industries	1,308.0	1,314.0	▲	0.5
Adani Ports & SEZ	1,695.0	1,697.0	▲	0.1
ICICI Bank	1,418.0	1,419.0	▲	0.1
HDFC Bank	727.4	727.5	▲	0.0
Titan	5,079.0	5,080.0	▲	0.0
Bajaj Finserv	2,030.0	2,028.7	▼	-0.1
NTPC	341.0	340.1	▼	-0.3
Tata Steel	183.4	182.6	▼	-0.4
M & M	3,439.0	3,417.0	▼	-0.6
Sun Pharma	1,924.9	1,900.9	▼	-1.2
Ultratech Cement	11,715.0	11,551.0	▼	-1.4
Maruti Suzuki	13,865.0	13,580.0	▼	-2.1
SBI	1,068.0	1,045.4	▼	-2.1
Trent	2,990.0	2,922.5	▼	-2.3
Bharti Airtel	1,992.0	1,946.9	▼	-2.3
Asian Paints	2,710.0	2,640.2	▼	-2.6
TCS	2,359.0	2,298.0	▼	-2.6
ITC	277.6	269.8	▼	-2.8
Tech Mahindra	1,634.7	1,583.1	▼	-3.2
HUL	2,089.3	2,017.0	▼	-3.5
HCL Tech	1,360.0	1,304.0	▼	-4.1
Infosys	1,169.1	1,120.0	▼	-4.2
Tata Motors PV	334.2	317.7	▼	-4.9

How sectoral indices moved

	Aug 14	Aug 21	Movement	% change
REALTY	6,997.7	7,108.5	▲	1.6
METALS	41,547.7	41,795.6	▲	0.6
BANKEX	65,270.6	65,368.8	▲	0.2
AUTO	64,614.1	64,260.7	▼	-0.5
CONSUMER DURABLES	65,702.8	65,276.3	▼	-0.6
OIL&GAS	26,273.2	26,090.6	▼	-0.7
PSU	20,903.5	20,729.2	▼	-0.8
HEALTHCARE	50,976.0	50,545.2	▼	-0.8
CAPITAL GOODS	80,120.0	79,219.8	▼	-1.1
POWER	7,643.4	7,541.7	▼	-1.3
FMCG	18,293.3	17,980.5	▼	-1.7
TECK	15,920.0	15,509.3	▼	-2.6
IT	30,121.4	29,334.1	▼	-2.6

WHO AM I?.

Are you an avid investor? How well do you know corporate India?

Here's a challenge. Using the five clues below, identify the company that is being talked about here

- I was founded 70 years ago by one of India's industrial houses of the 1950s, which underwent a family split in the 1990s.
- I acquired a company from an MNC at half the price it had paid to buy it from my founder's cousin a decade earlier.
- I am the largest shareholder in another listed company that has delivered negative returns over the last 10 years.
- I have had the same CMD for about four decades, and his compensation reached 500 times the median employee remuneration a couple of years ago.
- I have delivered a CAGR of over 20 per cent to my shareholders despite being in a commodity business, thanks to strong growth in a business I diversified into a few years ago.

Send your answers by Wednesday 6 p.m. to who-am-i@thehindu.co.in, with your full name, postal address and phone number. A lucky winner in each week will get a book sponsored by UNIFI Capital as a reward.

Contributed by

UNIFI CAPITAL
Investing With Conviction

Last week's stock: Go Fashion (India)

Last week's winner: Murali Gopalswamy

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Nifty 50 (24,252) lost 0.5 per cent last week whereas Nifty Bank (57,762) gained 0.5 per cent, showing a divergence in performance. Below is the analysis of the futures contracts and also other derivatives data of both indices.

Note that since August contracts are expiring on Tuesday (August 25), we shall consider September contracts for analysis and trade recommendations.

NIFTY 50
Nifty futures (Sep) (24,391) witnessed a sharp drop in price in the first half of last week. After marking a low of 24,212 by mid-week, the contract rebounded.

The chart shows that the September futures has support levels at 24,250 and 24,100. So long as these levels are valid, the upward inclination will hold and the contract can move up.

From the current level, the nearest resistance for September futures is at 24,600. A rally past this level can lift the contract to 24,850.

Instead, if there is a decline that can lead to the breach of the support at 24,100, the near-term trend can turn bearish. Notable support below 24,100 is at 24,000 followed by 23,800.

But unlike the chart, the futures and options data are showing mixed signs.

The September futures, which slipped 0.8 per cent last week, saw its outstanding open interest rise from nearly 18 lakh contracts over the last week, denoting a short build-up.

However, one should note that the increase is also because of



August contracts nearing its expiry.

Nevertheless, the Put Call Ratio (PCR) of August and September options stood at 1.1 and 1.3 respectively. A ratio greater than 1 is a positive sign because this shows traders have sold comparatively more put options. Traders sell puts when they hold positive expectations.

Considering the above factors, there is a reasonably good chance for Nifty futures (Sep) to witness a rally.

Strategy: Buy Nifty futures (Sep) if it slips to 24,300. Place stop-loss at 24,080. Target can be 24,750.

NIFTY BANK
Nifty Bank futures (Sep) (58,044) saw some moderation in the first half of last week. However, the selling pressure was low when compared to what Nifty futures experienced.

POSITIVE SIGNS

- Important support levels hold
- Futures and option data broadly bullish
- Traders can initiate fresh longs

For over three weeks, the September futures has been in a sideways trend. That is, it has been oscillating between 57,500 and 58,500. So, technically, until the contract moves out of this range, the path of next price swing will remain uncertain.

A breakout of 58,500 can strengthen the bulls and lead to a fresh leg of rally. This up move can take Nifty Bank futures to 59,300 and subsequently to 60,000.

However, if the contract

breaches the support at 57,500, it can result in a decline to 57,000. Potential support below 57,000 is at 56,500.

With respect to derivatives, the September contract closed flat last week. But the outstanding open interest rose from about 2 lakh contracts to 9 lakh contracts over the last week. Even though the futures closed flat, the underlying Nifty Bank index gained 0.5 per cent. So, the increase in open interest can be associated with a bullish sign.

The PCR of September options stood at nearly 1.4, showing a positive inclination among option traders.

Given the above factors, it can be said that the probability for Nifty Bank futures to rally is high.

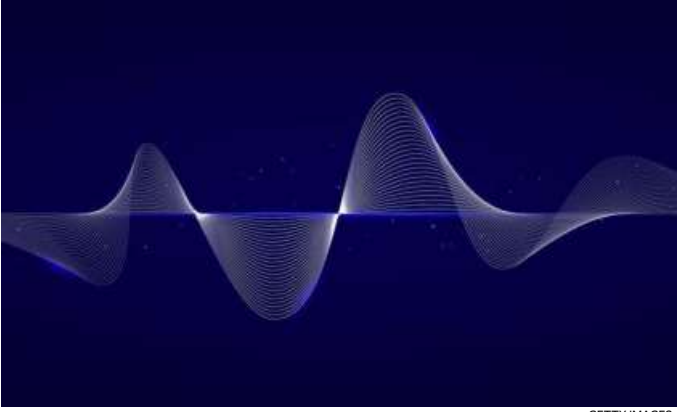
Strategy: Go long on Nifty Bank futures (Sep) now at 58,044 and place a stop-loss at 57,300. Book profits at 59,300.

Understanding volatility levels

MASTERING DERIVATIVES. It is the graph of volatility of a particular strike across expiries

Venkatesh Bangaruswamy

Volatility is an important factor in pricing options. Traders compare volatility of various strikes for a given expiry to determine whether a strike is rich or cheap. Likewise, they compare the current levels of volatility with historic volatility to determine whether all options on an underlying are currently priced or not. This week, we discuss what you should be mindful of when you observe the levels of implied volatility across expiries.



RISK FACTOR

Time decay could drag your returns

lysts structuring over the counter option products combine both volatility skew graph and term structure of volatility to meaningfully price a product. The combined three-dimensional graph is called volatility surface.

TIME DECAY
Options traders use a different version of term structure of volatility graph to compare current volatility levels in the mar-

ket with historic volatility levels. Instead of using the same strike across expiries, traders use ATM strike for each expiry to compare the volatility levels. An ATM strike is the one just above an underlying's price at any given point in time. How is this graph useful? Suppose you have a positive outlook on an underlying and want to initiate a long position. You observe that the implied volatility of the ATM strike has increased from, say, 12 per cent to 17 per cent over the last three weeks.

The increase in implied volatility levels indicates that options are trading rich. Therefore, the risk is that time decay could drag

your returns. This could happen because higher implied volatility is a function of higher time value. And higher time value results in larger time decay with each passing day. This could drag the gains from increase in option price associated with the underlying price movement (delta gains). You could choose to instead initiate long futures position, as futures do not suffer from time decay like options do.

Optional Reading
You must first determine the ATM strike for each day when you compare current levels of volatility over time. For instance, if you are interested in observing how the implied volatility of the ATM strike moves over the past three weeks, you should first take the closing price of the underlying for each day over the last three weeks. Then pick the ATM strike for each day and determine its implied volatility using the Black-Scholes-Merton option valuation model. You should then graph the data to understand how the implied volatility of ATM strike has changed over the observed period.

The author offers training programmes for individuals to manage their personal investments

Strong momentum Rally may extend

BULLION CUES. Traders can consider longs

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Precious metals witnessed a considerable rally last week. Gold (\$4,603/ounce) and silver (\$69/ounce) were up 5.2 per cent and 6.6 per cent respectively. Similarly, in the domestic market, gold futures (₹1,62,438/10 gm) rallied 5.1 per cent and silver futures (₹2,46,597/kg) gained 4.5 per cent.



the contract rises to ₹1,67,000, tighten the stop-loss to ₹1,65,000. Book profits at ₹1,70,000.

MCX-Silver (₹2,46,597)
Silver futures (Sept), which saw a dip early last week, found support at ₹2,30,000. This is an important support where both 21- and 50-day moving averages coincide.

The contract rebounded on the back of this, rallied and broke out of ₹2,40,000, a good indication that the outlook has turned bullish.

We expect silver futures to touch ₹2,60,000 in the near term. On the other hand, if the contract falls from the current level, it can find support at ₹2,40,000. A breach of this can lead to a deeper decline to ₹2,30,000.

Trade strategy: Buy silver futures at ₹2,44,000. Target and stop-loss can be ₹2,60,000 and ₹2,39,000 respectively.

CRUDE CHECK. Participants can buy the dips

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Oil prices extended the gain last week. Brent crude oil futures on the Intercontinental Exchange (ICE) (\$94.40/barrel) and crude oil futures in the domestic market (₹8,359/barrel) gained 6.6 per cent and 7 per cent, respectively.



BRENT FUTURES (\$94.40)
Brent crude futures broke out of the resistance at \$91 early last week.

It gained further to mark a high of \$94.83 on Friday before ending the week a little lower at \$94.40.

The price action suggests that the uptrend is steady and the likelihood of further gains is high.

While \$98 is the nearest hurdle, Brent crude futures can surpass this to move up to \$101.

On the other hand, if there is a decline, leading to a fall below \$91, the contract might drop to \$87.60 and \$86. So as long as these levels hold, the outlook will be positive.

MCX Crude Oil (₹8,359)
Crude oil futures (Sep) sur-

passed the resistance at ₹8,000 last week. It rose to hit an intra-week high of ₹8,404 on Thursday before wrapping up the week at ₹8,359.

The chart shows that the bulls are in a good position to push the contract further higher from the current level. The nearest resistance is at ₹8,600. But crude oil futures can rise above this and touch ₹9,000.

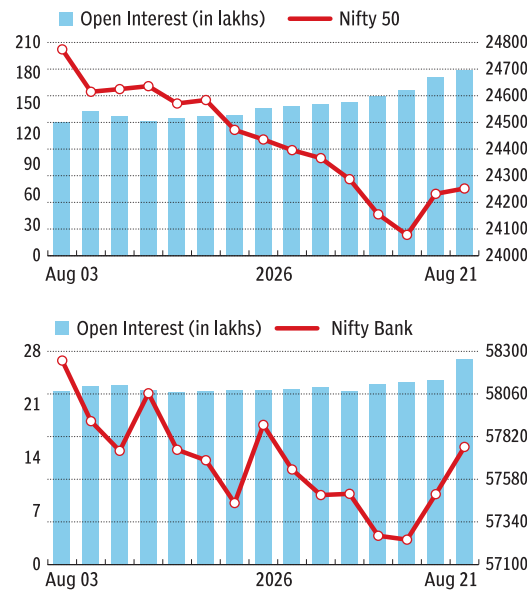
On the other hand, if the contract falls from the current level, the support at ₹8,000 can arrest the decline.

In case this is breached, the downtick can extend to ₹7,600.

Nevertheless, the bias is positive at the moment.

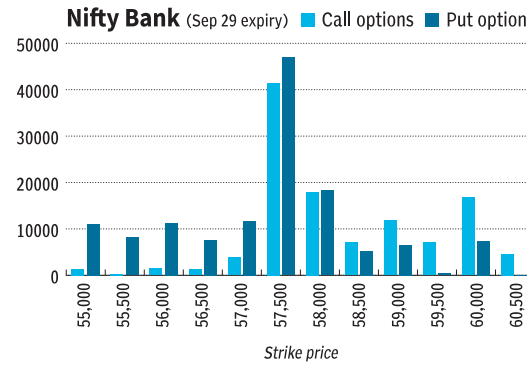
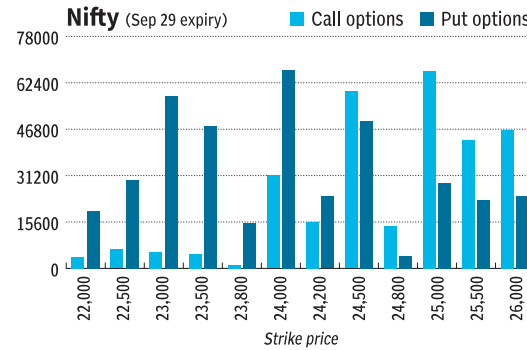
Trade strategy: Buy crude oil futures (Sept) at ₹8,200. Place stop-loss at ₹7,900. Book profits at ₹8,800.

Cumulative Open Interest (Futures)



Open Interest chain

(as on Aug 21)
Put-Call ratio Nifty **1.27** | Nifty Bank **1.37**



Change in Open Interest (OI)

Scrip	FII		Retail	
	As on Aug 21	Weekly change %	As on Aug 21	Weekly change %
Future Index Long	26060	2	228719	8
Future Index Short	235915	17	57703	3
Net Futures	-209855	19	171016	10
Index Call options Long	605959	13	3181286	-1
Index Call options Short	824072	1	3116422	1
Net Call options	-218113	-21	64864	-51
Index Put options Long	1107435	14	2927817	10
Index Put options Short	639488	34	3625353	11
Net Put Options	467947	-6	-697536	15

FII's have increased net short on index futures and index calls. But they've cut net short on index calls and reduced net long on index puts.

Stocks that witnessed major change in OI

Company	Price (₹)	Weekly price change %	OI (in lakh)	Weekly OI change %
RISE (as on Aug 21)				
KFINTech	980.00	4.3	165.0	67.2
VOLTAS	1,235.00	-6.5	266.1	48.4
MOTILALOFS	990.00	9.5	153.9	38.3
BRITANNIA	5,365.00	-3.5	56.0	37.6
BSE	3,241.00	-6.0	402.6	21.7
FALL (as on Aug 21)				
JUBLFOOD	506.75	0.5	521.4	-24.0
BHARATFORG	2,063.00	-0.1	216.6	-21.8
HDFC AMC	2,610.00	5.0	103.3	-20.0
ALKEM	5,400.00	0.6	29.6	-18.9
DALBHARAT	1,880.00	2.1	38.6	-18.4

Stocks in F&O ban (for trade on Aug 24)

SAIL

Change in OI and market positioning

Symbol	Expiry date (2026)	Price (₹)	OI	Indication
(Weekly change %)				
COMMODITIES (as on Aug 21)				
ALUMINIUM	31-Aug	347.9 (-0.2)	2,596 (-29)	Long unwinding
COPPER	31-Aug	1,385.4 (0.5)	7,352 (-23)	Short covering
CRUDEOIL	21-Sep	8,359.0 (7.0)	13,680 (67)	Long build-up
CRUDEOILM	21-Sep	8,357.0 (7.0)	41,742 (120)	Long build-up
GOLD	5-Oct	1,62,438.0 (5.1)	11,006 (12)	Long build-up
GOLDGUINEA	31-Aug	1,29,157.0 (4.9)	7,101 (-35)	Short covering
GOLDM	4-Sep	1,60,916.0 (5.0)	27,435 (-7)	Short covering
GOLDPETAL	31-Aug	16,133.0 (4.8)	1,10,510 (-32)	Short covering
GOLDTEN	31-Aug	1,60,889.0 (5.0)	18,580 (-12)	Short covering
LEAD	31-Aug	196.0 (-1.1)	565 (-14)	Long unwinding
NATURALGAS	25-Sep	269.7 (0.0)	29,566 (128)	Long build-up
SILVER	4-Sep	2,46,597.0 (4.5)	9,373 (-13)	Short covering
SILVERM	31-Aug	2,47,903.0 (4.5)	21,613 (-18)	Short covering
SILVERMIC	31-Aug	2,47,775.0 (4.5)	56,161 (-25)	Short covering
ZINC	31-Aug	407.7 (2.0)	2,165 (-28)	Short covering
CURRENCIES (as on Aug 21)				
USDINR	27-Aug	95.68 (0.2)	37,28,256 (35)	Long build-up
EURINR	27-Aug	112.00 (1.5)	6,178 (18)	Long build-up
GBPINR	27-Aug	130.84 (1.2)	26,323 (-3)	Short covering
JPYINR	27-Aug	60.20 (0.5)	338 (-6)	Short covering

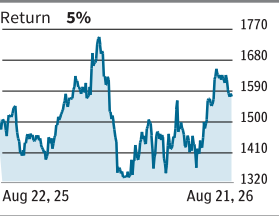
F&O Strategy

Buy Tech Mahindra futures

KS Badri Narayanan

The stock of Tech Mahindra (₹1,584) is ruling at a crucial level. Though the outlook remains negative, we expect a technical pull back.

Immediate resistance for the stock is at ₹1,625 followed by ₹1,689. A close above the latter will alter the short-term negative outlook whereas a close above ₹1,716 will reconfirm the bullish outlook. Nearest support levels are at ₹1,503 and



₹1,422. A close below the latter has the potential to trigger the next leg of sell-off.

F&O pointers: Tech Mahindra August futures closed at ₹1,582.20 and September futures at ₹1,591.80 against the spot close of ₹1,584. The premium in September series indicates rollover of long positions. The counter witnessed a rollover of nearly 60 per cent, which is quite healthy.

Strategy: Buy Tech Mahindra September futures keeping initial stop loss at ₹1,566. If the stock opens on a flat to positive note, the stop loss can be shifted to ₹1,588. Target can be ₹1,618. This strategy is not applicable if Tech Mahindra September contract opens above ₹1,605 or below ₹1,580.

Futures need higher margin commitments and the market, particularly IT stocks, will remain volatile. Therefore, risk-averse traders can stay out.

Follow-up: As expected ITC moved with negative bias and hit our profit targets.

Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis and F&O positions. There is a risk of loss in trading

Short Take

Option P/L on expiry

bl. research bureau

On expiry, the profit and loss of an option is the difference between the strike price of the option that you bought and the price of the underlying. But remember, until expiry, the price of an option is influenced by several factors like time to maturity, implied volatility etc.

For understanding purpose, let us say you bought 100-strike call option of stock A for ₹10 (call option premium) and the stock is currently trading at ₹90. Assume that the stock appreciates, and, on expiry, it ends at ₹120.



The value of a call option on expiry will be the price of underlying on expiry minus the strike price and vice versa for a put option.

So here, the value of the option on expiry will be ₹120-100 i.e., ₹20.

Since you have spent ₹10 to buy this option, your net profit will be ₹20-10 i.e., ₹10. Had the stock closed at ₹110, you would have ended up in break-even and had it closed at ₹105, you would lose ₹5.

To find the break-even price of an option with respect to stock price, add premium paid to the strike price for a call option and subtract premium paid from the strike price for a put option.

So, maximum loss for call option buyers will be the premium paid (₹10 in above example) and maximum profit will be price of the underlying on expiry minus strike price of the option minus the premium paid to buy that option.

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

Nifty 50, Sensex and Nifty Bank index fell in the first half of last week. However, the benchmark indices recovered in the second half. Sensex and Nifty closed the week down by 0.47 and 0.6 per cent. Nifty Bank index on the other hand recovered all the loss and was up 0.47 per cent for the week.

Broadly, the support has held well on all the three indices in line with our expectation. That keeps intact our broader bullish bias. If the indices manage to sustain the bounce, there are good chances to see more rise going forward.

FPIS BUY
The Foreign Portfolio Investors (FPIs) continue to buy Indian equities. The equity segment saw a net inflow of about \$725 million last week. The FPIs were net buyers for the fifth consecutive week. We need to watch the FPI's action going forward. Any acceleration in their purchase will aid the Sensex and Nifty to scale new highs, going forward.

NIFTY 50 (24,252)
Short-term view: The 24,000-23,950 support zone mentioned last week has held very well. Nifty has risen back from the low of 24,025.65. If it manages to sustain this bounce, then a further rise to 24,500 is possible this week. An eventual break above 24,500 can then take the Nifty higher to 24,700-24,800.

The short-term picture will turn negative only if the index declines below 23,950. If that happens, a fall to 23,900 or 23,800 can be seen. But our preference is to see the Nifty sustaining above 23,950 and go higher.

Medium-term view: The broader 22,000-26,500 range is intact. Within that, we expect the Nifty to go up towards 26,500, the upper end of the range in the medium term.

The bias continues to remain positive. So, Nifty is likely to make a bullish breakout above 26,500 eventually. Such a break can trigger a fresh rally to 28,000 and 30,000 in the long term.

Nifty has to decline below 22,000 to prove our bullish view wrong.



NIFTY BANK (57,761.95)
Short-term view: The fall to 57,000 happened in line with our expectation and the bounce thereafter has also happened as expected. The bias is positive. Nifty Bank index can rise to 58,400 first. A break above 58,400 can then take the index further higher to 59,200 and 60,000 in the short term.

Immediate support is at 57,300. Below that, 57,000-56,700 will continue to act as a strong support. The index has to break 56,700 to come under pressure for a fall to 56,000 or lower. But the price action on the chart indicates less chances for a decline below 57,000 itself.

Medium-term view: The broader picture remains bullish. Nifty Bank index can rise to 65,000 in the medium term. A rise above 60,000 can clear the

way for this upmove. From a long-term perspective, the Nifty Bank index has the potential to target 68,000-69,000 on the upside.

We reiterate that series of supports are available at 55,000, 53,000 and 50,000. The index has to decline below 50,000 to negate the above-mentioned long-term bullish view. But that looks less likely.

SENSEX (77,540.83)
Short-term view: Sensex bounced back from its low of 76,822.89 last week. Near-term support is in the 77,000-76,700 region. As long as the index stays above this support zone, the bias will remain positive. Sensex can rise to 79,000 and even to 80,000 in the coming weeks.

The near-term picture will turn negative only if the index

NEAR-TERM TARGETS

- Nifty 50: 24,500, 24,700
- Sensex: 79,000, 80,000
- Nifty Bank: 58,400, 59,200

breaks below 76,700. If that happens, a fall to 76,000 or 75,800 can be seen. However, a fall beyond that is less likely.

Medium-term view: The broader 71,000-86,000 range is intact. Within this, we expect the Sensex to go higher towards 86,000, the upper end of the range in the medium term.

Eventually we can expect the index to make a bullish breakout above 86,000. Such a break can then trigger a fresh rally and take the Sensex higher to 90,000 and even 94,000 in the long term.

Sensex has to break below 71,000 to negate our bullish view and become bearish.

NIFTY MIDCAP 150 (23,407.70)
The index has been oscillating between 23,200 and 23,500 since the beginning of this month.

A breakout on either side of this range will determine the

short-term move. A break below 23,200 can take the index down to 23,000-22,950. Thereafter we can expect a strong bounce back move towards 23,200-23,300 and higher levels again.

On the other hand, a strong break above 23,500 can trigger a fresh leg of upmove towards 26,000-26,500 in the medium term. It will also keep our overall bullish bias intact for the Nifty Midcap 150 index to target 28,000-28,500 in the long term.

The level of 22,800 is a key support to watch. The short-term picture will turn negative only if the index declines below this support. If that happens, we can get a fall to 22,400-22,200. However, that will not disrupt the broader bullish view. It will only delay the rise to 26,500 and 28,500.

NIFTY SMALLCAP 250 (18,414.45)

As expected, the index fell to test 18,200 and then has risen back very well. The bias is positive to breach 18,450, the immediate resistance and rise to 18,700-18,750 in the coming weeks.

That in turn will keep the upside open to see 22,500-23,000 in the medium term. From a big picture, the Nifty Smallcap 250 index has the potential to target 24,000-24,500 in the long term.

The region between 18,200 and 18,000 will continue to act as a strong support zone. The short-term picture will turn negative if the index breaks below 18,000.

Such a break can drag the index down to 17,400-17,300. This in turn will delay the rally to 24,000-24,500 mentioned above.

However, a fall below 18,000 is less likely as it will require a strong negative trigger.

bl.portfolio
video

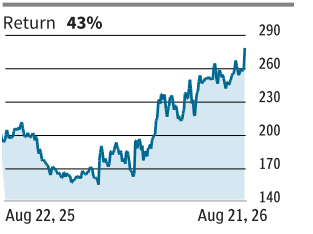
Watch **bl. Guru** share the Nifty and Bank Nifty technical outlook for this week

English Tamil

MOVERS & SHAKERS

AKHIL NALLAMUTHU, bl. research bureau

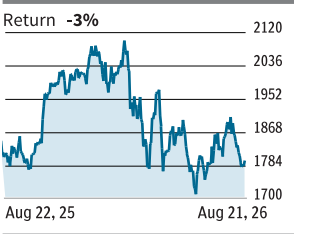
Jindal Saw (₹291.55)
Sees a fresh breakout



The stock of Jindal Saw appreciated about 10 per cent last week. Consequently, it broke out of the resistance at ₹280, and it hit a fresh 52-week high of ₹298.35 on Friday. The breakout has strengthened the uptrend, and the probability of

further rise is high. Going ahead, the stock might moderate to ₹270-280 price band and then see an uptick to ₹330. At this level, there is a chance for consolidation or a minor correction. After this, we expect the stock to rally to ₹400. So, buy now at ₹291 and accumulate at ₹280. Place stop-loss at ₹250. On a rally to ₹330 and ₹380, trail the stop-loss to ₹300 and ₹360 respectively. Exit at ₹400.

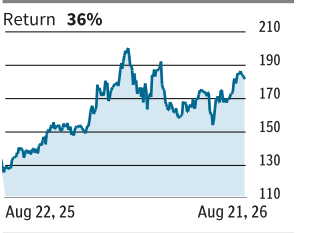
SBI Life Insurance Company (₹1,795)
Rebound likely soon



Since April, the stock of SBI Life Insurance Company has been oscillating in the wide range of ₹1,735-1,925. The chart shows that the price band of ₹1,700-1,750 is a strong support band and so long as this holds, the broader uptrend will be positive. We expect the

stock to gain traction soon and establish a fresh leg of rally. While there is a resistance at ₹1,915, the scrip can surpass this level and rise to ₹2,050 over the medium-term. Traders can buy now at ₹1,795 and accumulate at ₹1,740. Place initial stop-loss at ₹1,680. When the stock rises to ₹1,950 and ₹2,000, tighten the stop-loss to ₹1,880 and ₹1,960 respectively. Exit at ₹2,050.

Union Bank of India (₹183)
Outlook is positive



The stock of Union Bank of India has been rallying since early July after it found support at ₹154. In the first week of this month, it surpassed a key barrier at ₹178, which turned the trend bullish. The stock is likely to rise from the current level of ₹183 or

after softening to ₹178. On the upside, the stock has the potential to rise to ₹220. That said, after reaching ₹200, we might see a pause in the uptrend before it eventually goes up to ₹220. Buy now at ₹183 and accumulate at ₹178. Keep initial stop-loss at ₹170. When the stock reaches ₹195 and ₹210, revise the stop-loss to ₹185 and ₹200 respectively. Book profits at ₹220.

Brief pullback



Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

The Dow Jones Industrial Average, S&P 500 and NASDAQ Composite index closed in the red last week. The Dow Jones, down 0.85 per cent, fell for the second consecutive week. The S&P 500 was down 1.43 per cent. The NASDAQ Composite index was beaten down the most. The index fell 2 per cent for the week.

The short-term picture looks slightly weak. There is some room for the US benchmark indices to fall further from here. However, key supports are there which can halt the current fall. The price action around the supports will need a close watch this week. We expect the indices to bounce back from their support.

DOW JONES (53,282.32)
Support is at 52,400 which can be tested this week. A bounce from this support and a subsequent rise above 53,400 will be bullish. Such a rise can take the Dow Jones higher to 54,700 and 55,000 again. That will also keep the upside open to see 56,000 eventually.

If the index breaks below 52,400, an extended fall to 52,000 can happen. The above-mentioned rise to 55,000-56,000 will get negated only if the Dow Jones breaks below 52,000. In that case, the outlook will turn negative, and the index can fall

● CRUCIAL SUPPORT

The US dollar index has to sustain above 98, a crucial support to avoid further fall

to 51,000 and lower.

S&P 500 (7,674.37)
The fall last week looks just like a correction. Immediate supports are at 7,630 and 7,600 which can be tested this week. Below that 7,550 is a very strong support. The short-term picture will turn negative only if the index declines below 7,550.

We expect the S&P 500 index to sustain above 7,600 itself and reverse higher. That will keep intact our broader bullish view. The index can then go back up to 7,800. A decisive break above 7,800 can then clear the way for the rise to 8,000. As mentioned last week, the price action around 8,000 will be very crucial.

NASDAQ COMPOSITE (26,180.45)
Immediate support is at 26,000. A bounce from here and a subsequent rise above 26,500 will strengthen the case for a rise to 27,000. If the index manages to breach 27,000, then an extended rise to 28,000 is a possibility.

From a big picture, a rise beyond 28,000 might be difficult. As such we expect the upside to be capped at 28,000. So, as the index goes up towards 27,000-28,000, it is important

to become more cautious than overly bullish.

In case the index declines below 26,000 from here, then 25,500 and lower levels can be seen.

DOLLAR OUTLOOK
The dollar index (98.85) fell sharply last week. Indeed, it has declined below the key support level of 99 contrary to our expectation. The region between 99 and 99.20 will be a very good resistance now.

The near-term picture looks weak for a fall to 98.20-98, a crucial support zone. A bounce from this support region and then a subsequent rise above 99 is needed to get some breather. Only then the bias will turn positive for a rise to 101 again.

In case the index breaks below 98, a fall to 97.60 is possible. A further break below 97.60 will increase the danger of seeing 96 on the downside.

The price action this week is going to be very crucial.

TREASURY YIELD
The US 10Yr Treasury Yield (4.74 per cent) remained within the 4.6-4.75 per cent range. Our bias is bullish to see a breakout above 4.75 per cent and a rise to 4.8 per cent first. An eventual break above 4.8 per cent will then clear the way for a rise to 5 per cent.

In case the yield declines below 4.6 per cent, it can fall to 4.5-4.45 per cent and not beyond that.

Chart-Gazing • bl • 7

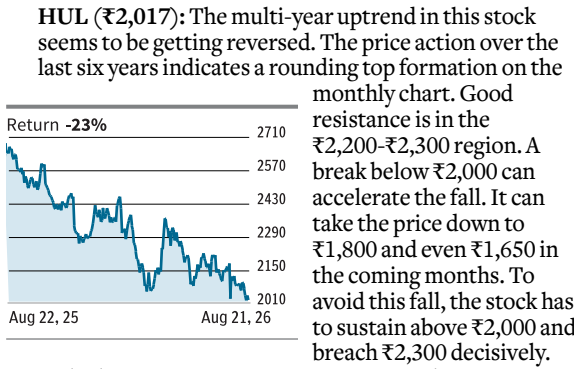
TECH QUERY



GURUMURTHY K
bl. research bureau

I have Hindustan Unilever (HUL) shares bought at ₹2,443 in 2023 for a five-year time horizon. Should I continue to hold the stock or exit?

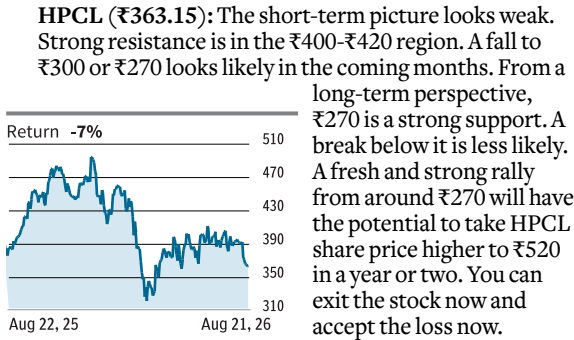
Deepthi



Only then a rise to ₹2,500 can come into the picture again. But that looks less likely. So, it is better to exit the stock and accept the loss.

What is the short- and long-term outlook for Hindustan Petroleum Corporation (HPCL)? I have bought this stock at ₹430.

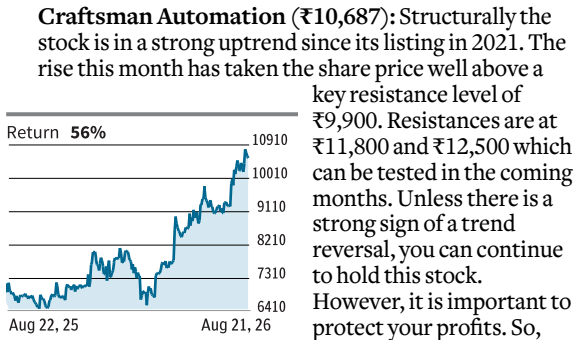
Anand G



again at ₹295 and ₹280. Keep a stop-loss at ₹210. Move the stop-loss higher to ₹320, ₹390 and ₹450 when the share price goes up to ₹410, ₹480 and ₹500, respectively. Exit the stock at ₹520.

I am holding Craftsman Automation shares since its IPO. What is the long-term outlook?

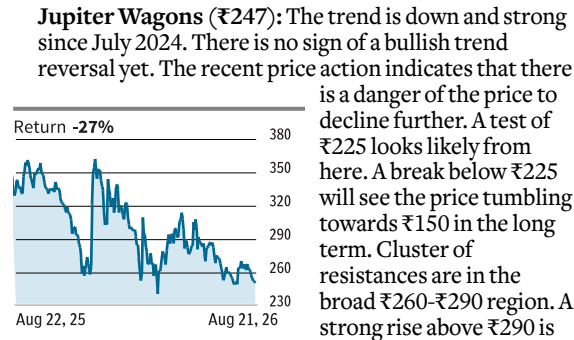
Pradeep Kamath



and hold the stock. Move the stop-loss higher to ₹9,975 as soon as the stock goes up to ₹11,600. Thereafter for every ₹500 move up revise your stop-loss higher by ₹200. Continue to hold the stock until your stop-loss is hit.

What is the long-term outlook for Jupiter Wagons?

Manohar Joshi



to ₹320-₹350. Ideally, the stock has to rise past ₹350 to indicate a trend reversal and become bullish. Only then a rise back to ₹500-₹600 levels will come into the picture. But that looks unlikely now. It is better to stay out of this stock for now.

● Send your queries to techtrail@thehindu.co.in

BANDU'S BLOCKBUSTERS.

On April 1, four years back, piqued by the incessant jokes in the village at his expense, Bandu Barve decided he'd had enough. It was time for him to turn 'smart'. His dead granny's voice rang in his ears — "Read the papers, Bandya, they tell you all." So, off went Bandu to the stash of newspapers on his father's desk. As luck would have it, the first paper Bandu got his hands on was The Hindu businessline. The stock recos, in particular, had him in thrall. Soon Bandu metamorphosed into an ace investor and trader.

These days, Bandu picks five stocks each Sunday, which he believes will be blockbusters over the next week

1 MCX

2 Action Construction Equipment

3 Brigade Enterprises

4 IFCI

5 Eternal

Last week's prize winner
Nirmal Kumar Agarwala

Last week's winning stock
APL Apollo Tubes

Closing price (Aug 14)
₹2,094

Closing price (Aug 21)
₹2,138.50

Return:
2.13 per cent

Here's your chance to match step with Bandu. Guess the stock that will give the best return by next Friday (BSE prices). By Wednesday noon, mail us your pick and its expected price rise to bandublockbuster@gmail.com with your name, mobile number and address. One lucky winner will get a prize of ₹2,000.

businessline portfolio

SUNDAY - AUGUST 23 - 2026

Valuation Radar: The Good, The Bad, The Ugly

The Benchmark indices, Sensex and Nifty 50 were down 0.6 and 0.5 per cent respectively last week. BSE Realty gained the most by 1.6 per cent, followed by BSE Metal 0.6 per cent and BSE Bankex 0.2 per cent. BSE IT and BSE Teck declined by 2.6 per cent each respectively last week.

	Nifty 50	Sensex	Auto	Bankex	Capital Goods	Consumer Durables	FMCG	Healthcare	IT	Metal	Oil & Gas	Power	PSU	Realty	Teck
P/E	20.5	20.5	38.0	13.9	53.0	64.3	33.2	44.4	19.9	17.6	11.7	31.8	11.6	41.6	20.5
P/BV	2.9	4.2	7.8	2.3	15.4	17.9	7.5	7.9	6.0	3.3	1.6	4.9	2.2	5.7	8.0
Dividend Yield	1.2	1.1	1.0	0.7	0.5	0.5	0.9	0.5	2.6	2.3	2.3	1.1	2.0	0.5	1.7
Weekly Return (%)	-0.5 ▼	-0.6 ▼	-0.5 ▼	0.2 ▲	-1.1 ▼	-0.6 ▼	-1.7 ▼	-0.8 ▼	-2.6 ▼	0.6 ▲	-0.7 ▼	-1.3 ▼	-0.8 ▼	1.6 ▲	-2.6 ▼
Monthly Return (%)	0.3 ▲	0.1 ▲	7.1 ▲	-0.3 ▼	0.8 ▲	2.4 ▲	-1.6 ▼	-0.2 ▲	4.9 ▲	2.8 ▲	-2.3 ▼	-4.5 ▼	-1.0 ▼	-1.8 ▼	3.0 ▲
Annual Return (%)	-3.3 ▼	-5.4 ▼	13.2 ▲	5.2 ▲	18.1 ▲	7.1 ▲	-13.3 ▼	12.9 ▲	-16.3 ▼	32.1 ▲	-1.3 ▼	14.4 ▲	9.1 ▲	-0.2 ▼	-10.4 ▼

The sector indices are disseminated by BSE PSE.

Company	CMP	EPS	PE	PB	Year End	Sales	Profit	Sales TTM	Profit TTM	Wkly Rtn	ROCE	DER	Yr-High	Yr-Low
360 ONE [1]	1198.0	31.0	38.7	5.3	202606	34.5	16.1	36.8	19.5	-2.7	12.1	1.6	1235.7	906.2
3M India [1]	33659.2	542.7	62.0	17.7	202406	-0.3	21.6	3.0	23.3	-4.6	39.8	0.0	38300.0	22874.7
A B B [2]	7412.0	72.7	101.9	16.8	202606	21.0	8.0	10.0	-13.0	-3.0	9.8	0.1	7923.4	4640.5
A B Lifestyle [1]	86.1	1.7	49.2	7.4	202606	11.1	20.6	9.1	31.5	-3.0	12.5	2.2	151.2	86.0
A B Real Estate [1]	1402.9	-29.2	4.2	2.02606	3.0	-255.2	-55.2	-267.7	0.1	-4.1	1.4	1974.5	1080.1	
Aadhar Energy Sol. [1]	463.0	26.3	17.6	2.7	202606	17.1	19.0	17.7	21.5	-7.2	11.3	2.5	563.0	425.1
Aarti Industries [5]	526.8	4.4	36.6	1.0	202606	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0
AAVAS Financiers [1]	1355.1	61.9	21.9	2.9	202403	21.4	12.3	25.4	14.2	-2.9	9.9	3.2	1775.0	1050.3
Abbott India [1]	26245.6	759.9	34.5	11.7	202606	4.3	17.1	6.3	11.2	-3.1	43.8	0.0	32950.0	25164.0
ACC [1]	1307.7	101.2	12.9	1.2	202606	-4.6	56.3	11.5	-18.6	-1.0	11.0	0.0	1986.9	1250.0
ACME Solv Hold. [2]	401.6	3.4	47.7	3.6	202606	6.78	64.8	47.5	45.4	7.3	7.4	2.8	411.2	195.7
Action Const.Eng. [2]	118.21	36.7	32.2	7.0	202606	20.5	22.3	5.2	3.3	8.9	40.2	0.0	1159.8	74.0
Acuteas Chemical [5]	3168.6	47.2	67.2	15.7	202606	59.1	67.7	40.9	104.3	-2.0	20.1	0.1	3735.0	1290.1
Adani Energy Sol. [1]	1531.1	23.9	64.1	6.5	202606	42.4	124.2	20.9	21.8	-5.3	9.5	1.9	1789.0	745.0
Adani Enterp. [1]	2295.0	19.0	157.5	4.3	202606	49.9	14.9	18.1	-28.8	-1.5	5.6	1.5	3245.0	1753.3
Adani Green [1]	1131.0	11.9	110.1	11.2	202606	15.6	16.6	7.2	1.0	-2.2	8.0	5.7	1631.4	767.1
Adani Ports [2]	1697.0	57.7	29.4	4.1	202606	18.6	9.2	23.8	16.8	0.1	13.8	0.7	1891.8	1293.1
Adani Power [2]	205.0	7.4	27.7	6.4	202606	30.0	42.0	6.6	14.9	-0.1	16.6	0.8	254.2	116.7
Adani Total Gas [1]	646.3	57	112.4	14.6	202606	27.2	-14.2	19.8	-2.4	-1.1	14.8	0.5	859.7	453.5
Aditya AAMC [5]	1008.3	34.9	28.9	7.2	202606	3.5	11.7	6.6	3.9	-0.3	32.2	0.0	1224.4	708.5
Aditya Bkr. Fsc. [1]	54.4	-6.1	1.1	202606	1.0	-201.5	11.4	-1.4	-2.9	0.0	0.9	0.9	55.0	53.6
Aditya Birla Cap. [1]	412.0	14.7	28.0	2.9	202606	28.2	40.1	16.3	18.2	-2.7	8.8	4.9	430.6	273.0
Aditya Infotech [1]	3476.3	40.3	86.2	21.9	202606	89.5	325.5	51.8	214.8	-1.2	28.1	0.3	4094.5	1186.1
Aegis Logistics [1]	1417.4	25.6	39.8	8.2	202606	35.1	26.9	30.4	88.7	12.1	16.1	0.8	1498.0	576.0
Aegis Vopak Term. [1]	276.2	2.4	113.0	9.0	202606	12.4	-7.0	26.1	42.9	2.6	8.7	1.9	311.5	158.8
Ager Industries [1]	1626.1	18.1	90.0	8.8	202606	27.2	28.0	34.4	30.4	-0.2	11.6	0.1	1690.0	723.2
Aikons Infotech [1]	278.0	5.6	49.9	1.9	202606	-20.8	-77.7	-11.9	-61.5	-3.4	10.5	0.6	479.1	259.2
Airfr [1]	172.4	3.9	41.6	3.4	202606	12.4	15.7	19.8	19.2	1.1	10.6	0.1	218.6	129.1
AIA Engineering [2]	4350.8	136.0	32.0	5.1	202606	12.4	-1.3	5.5	14.7	-3.1	19.1	0.1	5175.0	3000.6
Ajanta Pharma [2]	3640.4	90.8	40.1	10.1	202606	24.8	30.9	20.2	22.0	-0.9	31.8	0.0	3797.0	2335.0
Alkem Lab [2]	1593.7	190.6	28.3	4.7	202606	10.9	-20.5	13.4	0.2	0.0	19.7	0.1	5933.0	5085.0
Allen Blenders [2]	584.9	19.5	74.6	3.7	202606	6.1	-13.0	8.0	-7.1	-0.8	18.3	0.6	720.0	382.7
Alor Industries [1]	11.6	-1.5	-0.2	202606	6.5	-178.8	3.9	18.6	-0.4	0.0	0.0	1.9	13.1	11.1
Amara Raja Ener. [1]	919.5	39.9	23.0	2.1	202606	23.9	15.9	12.7	-6.9	-2.8	11.7	0.0	1058.0	671.5
Amber Entorp. [1]	7349.6	56.1	131.0	5.9	202606	12.7	-3.4	14.6	-28.1	1.8	13.5	0.8	8970.0	5404.0
Amul Cements [1]	414.9	19.2	21.6	1.7	202606	17	-29.1	7.1	5.7	-0.6	6.7	0.0	400.0	394.0
Anand Rathil Wea. [1]	2186.3	28.0	78.1	36.4	202606	17.5	73.8	22.7	45.2	0.5	59.8	0.1	2229.9	1354.0
Anant Raj [2]	622.8	16.1	38.7	3.9	202606	6.6	18.9	17.0	25.7	-1.1	12.0	0.1	744.1	403.0
Angel One [1]	288.2	11.3	25.5	4.3	202606	25.4	102.1	9.1	3.8	0.4	14.8	1.0	364.1	20.9
Anglo Eastern [1]	217.5	6.4	31.2	6.2	202606	15.6	-11.7	-2.1	17.3	-0.1	11.8	0.2	240.0	159.0
Apur Industries [2]	16857.0	287.9	44.8	11.2	202606	29.2	77.8	24.0	36.4	0.9	32.6	0.1	11843.2	6800.0
APOLLO Tubes [2]	2138.5	44.3	48.3	11.2	202606	8.7	10.9	10.6	53.1	2.1	22.0	0.2	2300.9	1578.0
Apollo Hospitals [5]	8659.0	146.3	59.2	13.1	202606	20.6	34.2	17.2	33.7	-3.0	18.1	0.7	9326.8	6680.0
Apollo Tyres [1]	1047.7	33.6	13.1	1.7	202606	12.8	0.1	11.2	72.5	-1.3	13.4	0.3	540.3	365.4
Asahi India Paper [2]	2295.0	15.8	145.5	1.9	202606	12.8	12.8	12.8	12.8	12.8	12.8	12.8	12.8	12.8
Asahi India Glas [1]	964.3	17.5	55.1	6.3	202606	14.2	16.5	9.4	37.0	2.7	13.1	0.9	1073.0	775.1
Ashtok Leyland [1]	173.0	6.4	27.2	7.1	202606	11.7	0.8	16.4	17.1	-0.6	13.8	4.3	215.4	129.5
Aster DM Quality [1]	409.2	59.0	6.9	1.9	202606	21.6	17.0	15.7	28.3	-1.3	19.4	0.0	2085.5	2116.0
Aster DM Quality [1]	761.1	4.5	170.9	14.9	202606	21.6	-17.0	15.7	28.6	-7.5	11.6	0.5	891.0	511.9
Astral [1]	1535.5	22.1	69.6	10.2	202606	15.9	48.2	16.8	22.3	-1.9	14.1	0.1	1768.0	131.0
Ather Energy [1]	1460.4	-9.8	14.9	202606	88.8	-128.5	67.2	52.4	-3.4	0.0	0.4	1589.4	408.0	
Atul [1]	605.1	270.2	24.1	3.1	202606	25.0	92.0	15.8	59.1	-3.4	14.9	0.0	1182.8	563.0
Avg. Small Finance [1]	9.0	1.0	9.0	202606	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0
Aurobindo Pharma [1]	1620.0	65.1	24.9	2.5	202606	16.9	28.1	9.4	11.5	-2.3	12.4	0.2	1682.0	1017.0
Authum Invest [1]	55.28	24.7	2.24	3.2	202606	20.9	17.8	-34.6	-48.7	-2.2	29.7	0.1	63.5	40.0
Avenue Super [1]	3909.5	46.9	83.4	10.4	202606	14.9	11.3	15.6	13.0	-1.6	17.2	0.1	4163.8	3528.7
Avonlife Busine. [1]	188.3	0.1	188.3	0.2	202606	17.5	48.2	16.7	2.3	-2.1	17.1	0.2	229.9	171.2
Axis Bank [2]	1246.2	89.2	14.0	1.8	202606	9.9	22.2	5.6	-0.3	2.4	0.0	0.0	1418.3	1041.3

BHEL [2]	412.4	7.0	59.0	5.5	202606	40.3	-17.3	27.0	739.4	-2.3	5.6	0.3	446.8	205.2
BPCL [1]	311.0	35.7	8.7	1.4	202606	34.4	-154.5	12.3	-11.7	-2.3	24.9	0.6	319.9	266.6
Bajaj Finance [1]	11720.0	428.9	27.3	8.3	202606	65.0	45.9	36.3	55.2	0.2	28.4	0.4	11860.0	8490.1
Bajaj Finserv [1]	10942.0	32.9	33.2	6.0	202606	19.6	27.4	18.8	17.6	0.5	10.9	3.8	1177.6	788.4
Bajaj Holdings [1]	2028.7	64.9	31.2	4.2	202606	15.4	12.3	14.9	9.3	-0.1	11.8	5.2	1914.7	1598.5
Bajaj Finserv [1]	11460.0	795.8	14.4	1.7	202606	21.5	32.2	30.2	27.3	0.5	12.6	0.1	13868.2	8597.5
Bajaj Housing [1]	84.8	3.2	26.2	3.1	202606	17.1	22.6	16.3	19.4	0.6	8.8	4.4	117.0	72.6
Balakhishia Inds [2]	2349.1	72.7	32.3	4.2	202606	25.2	56.4	9.8	-3.3	-0.7	10.9	0.4	2775.0	1971.5
Banquepar Hindu Chn [1]	278.0	17.5	16.1	11.3	202606	12.8	12.8	12.8	12.8	12.8	12.8	12.8	12.8	12.8
Bandhan Bank [1]	175.2	8.4	20.9	1.1	202606	2.8	34.9	-0.2	-34.1	0.3	0.0	22.0	207	134.3
Bank of Baroda [2]	246.2	42.9	5.7	0.8	202606	6.8	68.2	4.9	14.1	-0.8	0.0	0.0	325.6	231.0
Bank of India [1]	142.6	25.9	5.5	0.8	202606	8.8	49.8	6.2	19.4	-0.9	0.0	0.0	174.5	13.7
Bank of Maha [1]	391.3	30.7	8.2	1.8	202606	13.9	34.5	15.8	31.0	-0.4	12.0	0.0	94.5	51.7
Bank of India [1]	70.1	13.5	51.9	5.7	202606	3.9	15.9	1.9	-20.7	-1.1	12.0	0.9	128.1	605.6
Bayer Crop Sci. [1]	4069.4	162.9	25.0	6.2	202606	-4.2	15.4	-2.8	23.6	0.5	28.0	0.0	5642.0	4030.0
Belrise Industri [5]	231.8	5.3	43.9	3.2	202606	12.6	8.9	11.6	29.1	-9.2	14.1	1.1	268.0	135.2
BELM Ltd [5]	1935.3	21.4	90.3	5.5	202606	29.3	-142.1	12.8	-40.3	3.3	11.7	0.1	2775.8	139.1
Bharat Electronics [1]	524.7	25.6	40.9	1.8	202606	18.2	12.5	15.5	16.3	-0.1	11.8	0.2	594.2	394.0
Bharat Dynamics [1]	1361.0	14.2	95.8	11.8	202606	14.8	54.7	-18.3	-7.1	-2.7	10.2	0.0	1655.3	1090.6
Bharat Electron [1]	413.5	8.4	49.2	12.6	202606	24.9	8.7	19.8	11.7	0.8	34.8	0.0	473.3	361.1
Bharat Forge [2]	206.2	21.2	97.5	10.3	202606	18.7	-57.6	17.5	-1.3	-0.6	11.7	0.7	2293.0	1100.5
Bharat Forge [2]	38.4	6.9	38.5	1.8	202606	14.8	19.3	12.7	19.3	0.0	12.0	0.0	38.4	19.3
Bharat Hoxcom [1]	1591.2	37.0	43.0	11.1	202606	10.9	23.2	7.9	28.6	-1.8	20.5	1.0	1950.5	1431.0
Bikaji Foods [1]	605.2	10.4	58.0	9.4	202606	13.1	0.4	14.6	29.2	-1.3	20.1	0.2	890.9	585.6
Billmarians [2]	197.2	3.9	50.7	12.8	202606	66.0	94.3	37.7	30.8	0.5	37.2	0.1	227.0	112.0
Bilcon [5]	441.1	4.5	92.5	2.0	202606	9.287	10.1	103.2	-0.2	3.8	0.6	44.7	440.7	337.2
Bilcon [5]	141.3	1.5	93.5	1.4	202606	1.4	18.2	1.2	2.2	-0.7	2.0	0.0	141.3	1.5
BLS International [2]	271.4	17.1	15.8	4.5	202606	25.3	11.2	31.8	24.9	-2.4	39.0	0.1	39.2	28.5
Blue Dart Express [5]	5073.3	136.6	37.1	6.8	202606	15.0	81.2	9.2	30.8	-1.4	17.1	0.7	7030.2	4630.5
Blue Star [2]	1510.8	25.7	58.7	9.1	202606	13.3	-21.0	-5.9	-0.9	0.3	19.6	0.2	1500.0	1450.0
Bluesol [1]	483.8	76.8	60.1	8.0	202606	12.0	12.0	12.0	12.0	12.0	12.0	12.0	12.0	12.0
Brant Solar [2]	196.4	-2.0	2.1	202606	13.1	-14.1	-11.7	24.2	-0.7	0.0	0.0	438.7	195.9	
Brigade Enterprise [1]	639.3	20.8	39.7	5.3	202606	-12.9	16.1	4.8	-9.6	8.0	10.7	1.0	10.6	451.3
Britannia Inds. [1]	5364.1	108.1	40.6	25.3	202606	9.5	13.6	7.5	18.7	-3.4	55.3	0.3	6337.0	5068.0

Sai Prabhakar Yadavalli
bl. research bureau

A parliamentary committee is considering caps on hospital room rents, linked to local three-star hotel rates, as well as limits on surgery costs. The proposal aims to contain medical inflation, which has accelerated since the post-Covid period.

To examine the issue from an insurance and claims perspective, we look at data released by Policybazaar.com. The insurance aggregator and composite broker analysed 8.7 lakh health insurance claims filed between 2021 and 2026. The study highlights how age, region and gender influence claims, and points to the growing burden of chronic conditions.

AGE FACTOR
Claims rise steadily with age. As the figure shows, the average claim for the 60-plus cohort is 170 per cent higher than that of the youngest cohort, aged 0-25 years. The study notes that younger policyholders typically claim for infections, injuries and maternity-related expenses, while older policyholders are more likely to claim for cardiac, cancer, kidney and other chronic illnesses.

The first takeaway is that health insurance should not be viewed as a product only for older people. Although claim amounts are lower among younger policyholders, the study reports that 56 per cent of claims came from the 26-45 age group. With more than half of claims arising from this younger cohort, health insurance is better seen as an age-agnostic form of protection.

This also matters because pre-existing disease, or PED, is the most common reason for claim rejection. Entering the health insurance net early helps policyholders complete the three-year PED waiting period and the five-year moratorium period sooner, after which claim rejections should be minimal.

The second takeaway is that insurance for the elderly, though expensive, may still be necessary. Annual premiums can range from ₹70,000 to ₹1 lakh, putting such cover out of reach for many households. However, the risk of remaining uninsured is also significantly higher, with the average claim for older policyholders at ₹1.8 lakh.

RISING IMPACT OF LIFESTYLE CONDITIONS
The study also underlines the

INSURANCE QUERY.



SHILPA ARORA

My parents are interested in Ayurvedic treatment. With a regular health insurance for my parents, I am concerned about how claims in Ayurvedic treatment will be handled. Can you please explain what to look for in Ayush-related claims in health insurance?

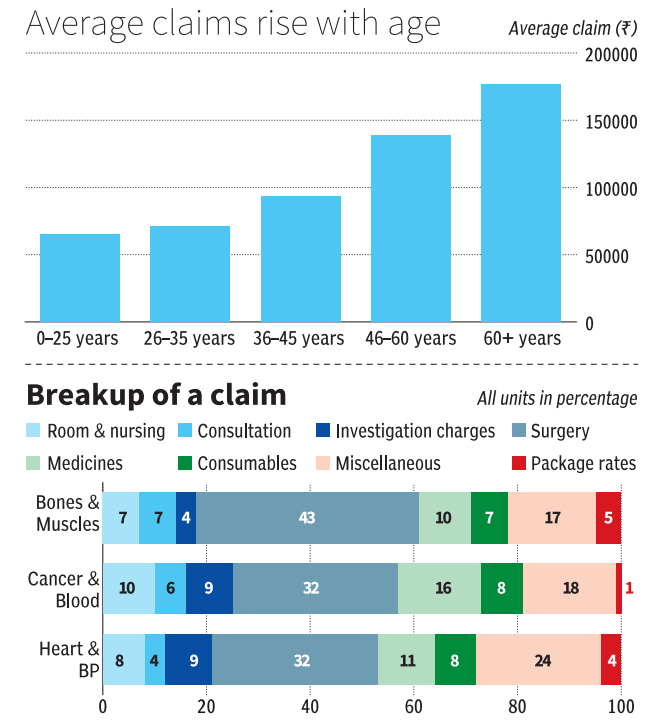
Preethi

Health insurance in India has evolved significantly over the past few years. Beyond conventional medical treatment, insurers today also provide coverage for AYUSH treatments — Ayurveda, Yoga & Naturopathy, Unani, Siddha and Homeopathy — giving policyholders greater freedom to choose the system of medicine best-suited to their needs. The IRDAI has progressively strengthened the regulatory framework for AYUSH coverage, including issuing dedicated guidelines in January 2024 to promote wider and more consistent coverage across health insurance products.

However, despite this regulatory push, AYUSH-related claim disputes continue to arise. In most cases, the dispute is not because AYUSH treatment is excluded, but because the policyholder is unaware of the policy conditions or the treatment does not meet the insurer's admissibility criteria.



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rising burden of chronic conditions in healthcare. These conditions persist for more than a year and may require lifelong care from the point of diagnosis. They include diabetes, cardiac ailments and kidney disease, many of which are also linked to lifestyle choices. For policyholders, this makes chronic illness a key financial risk to plan for.

The average claim amount for chronic conditions is ₹2.66 lakh, four times the average for non-chronic claims. As economies develop, healthcare demand typically shifts from acute, non-

chronic care to long-term chronic care, and India appears to be following that pattern. Although chronic conditions accounted for only 27 per cent of claims by number, they made up 42 per cent by value. Within this category, cancer and heart conditions together accounted for 22 per cent of claims by value.

Medical inflation is also highest in the chronic category. Cancer recorded annual claim inflation of 10-14 per cent, while heart and bone-related treatments saw annual inflation of 6-10 per cent, over the five-year

- SMART ADVICE**
- Buy health insurance early
 - Plan for chronic illness costs
 - Choose adequate cover based on location and needs

period. Given the high claim amounts and rising disease burden, policyholders need adequate cover with the PED period completed to ensure effective financial protection.

WOMEN-CENTRIC CARE
The study also focuses on women's health and high-risk areas beyond maternity care. Breast cancer claims averaged ₹7.5 lakh, and Policybazaar.com reports that the condition accounted for ₹99 crore in claims over the last five years. Reproductive health, maternity and benign breast tumours reported average claim amounts of ₹1.12 lakh, ₹50,000 and ₹86,000, respectively. These numbers underscore the need to prioritise women's healthcare, an area where several insurers already offer women-centric plans.

REGIONAL IMPACT
Regional differences further shape claim costs. The study finds that the average hospitalisation claim in Tier-1 cities is 44 per cent higher than in Tier-3 cities. For instance, Mumbai reported an average claim of ₹1.92 lakh, compared with ₹1.5 lakh in Faridabad. This



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policyholders often face difficulties. Incomplete admission records, missing prescriptions, inadequate discharge summaries, or improper bills can delay or even result in rejection of the claim. As with any health insurance claim, maintaining complete and accurate medical records is essential.

Pricing also plays an important role. We have observed instances where certain AYUSH centres charge significantly higher rates than those specified by the IRDAI. Where hospitals levy charges that are considered unreasonable or exceed the insurer's admissible limits, disputes may arise regarding the payable amount. The insurer may settle only the amount considered reasonable under the policy

terms, leaving the policyholder to bear the balance.

How can consumers avoid such disputes?

Before undergoing AYUSH treatment, policyholders should:

- * Read the policy wording carefully to understand whether any AYUSH-specific sub-limit applies.
- * Confirm that the treatment will be taken at a recognised AYUSH hospital or authorised healthcare facility.
- * Seek pre-authorisation from the insurer wherever cashless treatment is available.
- * Prefer network hospitals with existing cashless tie-ups, as these reduce documentation issues and improve claim experience.
- * Retain all prescriptions, investigation reports, bills, discharge summaries, and other medical records.
- * Clarify any doubts regarding admissibility with the insurer before beginning treatment rather than after hospitalisation.

AYUSH has become an important part of India's healthcare ecosystem, and insurance coverage has expanded accordingly. Yet, awareness has not kept pace with regulation. A little diligence before starting treatment, understanding the policy, selecting the right hospital and obtaining pre-authorisation can help policyholders avoid unnecessary disputes and ensure that they receive the benefits they are entitled to under their policy.

The writer Co-Founder and COO, Insurance Samadhan

Safe Investing • bl • 9

Bank FD interest rates (%)

Bank	<1 year	1 to 2 years	2 to 3 years	3 to 5 years	w.e.f
FOREIGN BANKS					
DBS Bank	6	6.85	6.4	6.4	May 06
Deutsche Bank	5	7	6.25	6.25	Jul 25
HSBC	4.1	5.5	5.35	5.5	Jul 17
Standard Chartered	5.75	6.6	6.5	6.5	Aug 01
INDIAN: PUBLIC SECTOR BANKS					
Bank of Maharashtra	5.25	6.65	5.25	5	Aug 10
Bank of Baroda	6	6.6	6.5	6.4	Jun 12
Bank of India	5.5	6.6	6.7	6.25	May 18
Canara Bank	5.5	6.6	6.25	6.25	Mar 17
Central Bank of India	6.5	6.75	6.25	6	Aug 10
Indian Bank	6.2	6.65	6.6	6.05	Aug 04
Indian Overseas Bank	5.5	6.6	6.4	6.1	May 15
Punjab National Bank	5.6	6.6	6.35	6.35	Jun 01
Punjab & Sind Bank	4.85	6.85	6.1	5.95	Jun 16
State Bank of India	5.9	6.45	6.4	6.3	Dec 15
UCO Bank	5	6.45	6.1	6	Apr 01
Union Bank	5.6	6.55	6.1	6	Aug 04
INDIAN: PRIVATE SECTOR BANKS					
Axis Bank	5.75	6.5	6.5	6.5	Aug 21
Bandhan Bank	4.20	7.45	7.45	7.25	Jun 20
CSB Bank	6.5	7.1	6.5	5.75	Aug 05
City Union Bank	6.25	7.25	6.5	6.25	Jun 16
DCB Bank	6.5	7.5	7.5	7.5	Aug 04
Dhanlaxmi Bank	7	7.1	6.5	7.25	Jul 23
Federal Bank	6	6.65	6.5	6.7	Aug 17
HDFC Bank	5.75	6.45	6.45	6.5	Aug 19
ICICI Bank	5.5	6.3	6.45	6.5	Aug 21
IDBI Bank	5.8	6.45	6.5	6.35	Feb 23
IDFC First Bank	6.5	7.25	7.25	6.75	Jul 25
IndusInd Bank	6.25	7	7	6.65	Jul 24
J & K Bank	6	6.75	6.8	6.85	Aug 01
Karnataka Bank	5.75	7	6.15	6.15	Jun 08
Kotak Bank	6	6.8	6.8	6.4	Jun 10
Karur Vysya Bank	7	7.2	6.55	6.55	Jun 08
RBL Bank	6.05	7.2	7.2	7	Sep 24
South Indian Bank	5.9	6.6	6.8	6.2	Jun 19
Tamilnad Mercantile Bank	6.5	7.25	7	6.7	Apr 10
TNSC Bank	6.85	7.6	7.1	6.85	NA
Yes Bank	6.5	7	7	6.75	Jun 02
SMALL FINANCE BANKS					
Equitas Small Finance Bank	6.35	7.1	7.75	8	Jun 16
ESAF Small Finance Bank	6	7.75	8	6	Aug 17
Jana Small Finance Bank	7	7.3	8	7.77	Aug 06
Suryoday Small Finance Bank	6.5	7.8	8.1	8.25	Aug 15
Utkarsh Small Finance Bank	6	8.1	7.5	7.25	May 05
Ujjivan Small Finance Bank	6	7.8	7.25	7.55	Jun 22

Data as on respective banks' website on 21 Aug 2026; For each year range, the maximum offered interest rate is considered; Interest rate is for a normal fixed deposit amount below ₹1 crore. Compiled by BankBazaar.com;

Small Savings Schemes - Interest rates

Small Savings Scheme		Interest rate (%)		Compounding frequency
		Apr 1 - Jun 30, 2026	Jul 1 - Sep 30, 2026	
Post Office Savings Deposit	1 year	6.9	6.9	Quarterly
	2 year	7.0	7.0	Quarterly
	3 year	7.1	7.1	Quarterly
	5 year	7.5	7.5	Quarterly
Post Office Recurring Deposit (5 year)		6.7	6.7	Quarterly
Senior Citizen Savings Scheme		8.2	8.2	Quarterly and paid
Post Office Monthly Income Scheme		7.4	7.4	Monthly and paid
National Savings Certificate		7.7	7.7	Annually
Public Provident Fund		7.1	7.1	Annually
Kisan Vikas Patra		7.5*	7.5*	Annually
Sukanya Samridhi Yojana		8.2	8.2	Annually

Note: Small savings rate as on the latest quarterly reset on June 30, 2026
*Will mature in 115 months Source: Department of Economic Affairs, Ministry of Finance, Govt of India

ALERTS.

PFRDA extends NPS e-shramik incentive

Pension regulator PFRDA has extended the onboarding incentive under the NPS e-shramik (Platform Service Partner) Model for FY27. Under the framework, Points of Presence (PoPs) can receive up to ₹100 for each new account onboarded under the model. The incentive, earlier applicable to platform service partners registered up to March 31, 2026, will now be valid for enrolments up to March 31, 2027.

Health insurance premium tracker

For a 30-year-old male, non-smoker, sum insured of ₹10 lakh living in a metro city

Insurer	Plan name	Key features	Premium (₹)
ICICI Lombard	Elevate	OPD rider with no sub-limits. Single pvt AC Room. ₹2 lakh NCB. Unlimited Restoration of cover.	7,792
Care	Care Supreme	Guaranteed 7x increase over 5 years with rider. No Room Rent Limit. ₹15 lakh Renewal Bonus; optional Unlimited Restoration of cover.	10,838
Niva Bupa Health	Health ReAssure	Unlimited claims up to the cover amount. No Room Rent Limit. ₹5 lakh NCB. Unlimited Restoration of cover.	12,033
Star Health	Super Star	Fully loaded plan with one-time unlimited claim. Unlimited bonus. Lock the age till 50. No Room Rent Limit. ₹5 lakh NCB.	8,173
Aditya Birla Health	Activ One Max	100% insurance offer guarantee. No Room Rent Limit. ₹10 lakh Renewal Bonus; optional Unlimited Restoration of cover	8,828
Tata AIG	Medicare Select	Special discount for young families and salaried customers. Single pvt AC Room. ₹5 lakh NCB. Unlimited Restoration of cover.	7,474
Reliance General	My HealthCare	Additional 30% discount on premium & fully customisable plan. Single pvt AC Room. ₹3.33 lakh NCB. Restoration of cover once a year.	7,326

Term insurance premium tracker

For a 30-year-old male/female, non smoker, living in a metro city, Sum assured ₹1 crore with coverage up to 70 yrs

Insurance company	Plan name	Max coverage up to	Max policy term	Annual premium		Claim settlement ratio (%)
		(years)	(years)	Male	Female	
Aditya Birla Capital	Super Term Plan	85	55	11,167	9,203	98.4
Bajaj Life	eTouch II	85	55	10,714	8,832	99.3
Canara HSBC Life	Young Term Plan - Life Secure	99	69	11,345	9,477	99.2
HDFC Life	Click 2 Protect Super	85	55	12,390	10,531	99.7
ICICI Prudential	iProtect Smart	99	69	14,462	9,645	99.3
Axis Max Life	Smart Term Plan Plus	85	55	11,217	9,527	99.7
SBI Life	Smart Shield Plus	79	49	13,206	11,109	99.4
TATA AIA Life	Sampoorna Raksha Promise	100	70	11,111	9,429	99.4
Bandhan Life	iTerm Prime	70	40	11,466	9,963	99.7

Claim settlement ratio as per data provided by insurer
Source: www.policybazaar.com, Date: August 22, 2026



b.l. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr.)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				Sortino Ratio (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	10 Year CAGR	
EQUITY - LARGE CAP FUNDS										
*****	ICICI Pru Large Cap	109.4	80960	1.1	0.7	-2.0	12.4	12.6	13.1	0.30
*****	Invesco India Largecap	73.3	1931	1.8	0.7	5.5	14.4	11.9	12.4	0.43
*****	Nippon Ind Large Cap	90.3	54225	1.2	0.6	-1.9	12.1	14.4	13.6	0.46
*****	Baroda BNP Paribas Large Cap	225.2	2632	1.7	0.7	2.0	12.4	11.3	12.1	0.33
*****	Canara Robeco Large Cap	62.5	17136	1.4	0.5	-1.7	11.0	9.5	12.8	0.27
*****	JM Large Cap	156.1	402	2.1	0.8	1.5	11.6	11.2	10.8	0.31
*****	SBI Large Cap	94.0	55431	1.2	0.7	1.2	10.2	10.5	11.4	0.31
*****	Aditya Birla SL Large Cap	527.1	29944	1.4	0.8	-0.6	11.0	10.5	11.3	0.30
****	Bandhan Large Cap	79.6	2145	1.7	0.8	2.3	13.4	11.1	12.1	0.32
****	DSP Large Cap	461.3	7228	1.5	0.8	-2.5	11.6	10.0	10.4	0.29
****	Edelweiss Large Cap	84.2	1443	1.8	0.6	0.4	10.4	10.1	11.9	0.29
****	Franklin Ind Large Cap	1035.7	7488	1.5	0.9	-0.4	11.2	9.3	10.3	0.24
****	HDFC Large Cap	1143.9	40198	1.3	0.8	0.0	10.6	12.5	12.1	0.37
****	HSBC Large Cap	483.1	1839	1.8	1.0	1.2	11.0	9.9	11.5	0.26
****	Kotak Large Cap	572.3	11028	1.5	0.6	-0.5	11.1	10.0	11.9	0.28
****	Mahi Manu Large Cap	22.4	711	2.0	0.7	-3.3	9.2	8.8	-	0.23
****	Tata Large Cap	513.5	2784	1.7	0.8	2.7	11.1	10.4	11.3	0.30
****	Groww Largecap	43.5	136	2.1	0.9	0.6	11.4	9.8	10.5	0.25
****	Mirae Asset Large Cap	113.5	38729	1.3	0.5	-0.2	9.5	8.9	12.0	0.24
****	Union Largecap	23.4	438	2.1	1.3	-0.7	8.9	8.6	-	0.22
****	DSP Large Cap	268.0	12303	1.5	0.8	-2.8	8.6	7.9	10.9	0.20
****	Axis Large Cap	61.0	31632	1.3	0.7	-0.4	10.2	6.7	11.6	0.15
****	LIC MF Large Cap	54.5	1387	1.9	0.9	-3.3	8.6	7.2	9.8	0.17
****	PGIM India Large Cap	335.4	547	2.1	0.8	-2.5	7.5	6.9	9.5	0.17
****	Taurus Large Cap	166.5	56	2.1	1.9	6.0	13.9	11.3	9.8	0.30
EQUITY - LARGE & MID CAP FUNDS										
*****	Bandhan Large & Mid Cap	142.0	19777	1.4	0.4	5.2	18.6	17.0	15.1	0.49
*****	ICICI Pru Large & Mid Cap	1061.0	32706	1.3	0.7	5.8	17.1	17.7	15.0	0.58
*****	Quant Large & Mid Cap	125.6	3496	1.7	0.6	11.4	15.5	16.4	15.3	0.43
*****	Axis Large & Mid Cap	35.4	16802	1.4	0.6	7.7	16.4	12.8	-	0.33
*****	HDFC Large and Mid Cap	352.3	30099	1.4	0.8	3.5	14.4	15.9	14.4	0.46
*****	Invesco India Large & Mid Cap	110.9	11746	1.5	0.6	7.0	23.1	17.6	16.0	0.46
*****	UTI Large & Mid Cap	187.9	6407	1.6	0.8	4.6	16.4	15.1	13.7	0.45
*****	BOI Large & Mid Cap Equity	93.9	514	2.1	0.9	7.1	14.3	12.4	12.4	0.33
****	DSP Large & Mid Cap	626.5	18231	1.4	0.5	1.8	14.7	12.8	13.7	0.36
****	Edelweiss Large & Mid Cap	92.0	4789	1.6	0.5	5.9	14.9	13.5	14.2	0.37
****	HSBC Large & Mid Cap	30.2	5479	1.6	0.7	11.9	18.9	15.2	-	0.35
****	Kotak Large & Midcap	356.4	32050	1.3	0.5	4.3	14.6	14.1	14.5	0.40
****	Mirae Asset Large & Midcap	159.0	45275	1.3	0.5	6.0	13.4	11.7	15.8	0.32
****	Nippon Ind Vision Large & Mid Cap	1522.3	7705	1.5	0.9	3.7	16.6	14.6	12.7	0.43
****	SBI Large & Midcap	653.7	42325	1.3	0.6	4.5	13.8	14.3	14.2	0.44
****	Canara Robeco Large and Mid Cap	262.6	26062	1.4	0.5	0.9	13.7	11.6	14.4	0.32
****	Franklin Ind Large & Mid Cap	195.9	3576	1.7	1.1	0.4	13.3	11.2	11.4	0.31
****	LIC MF Large & Midcap	39.8	313	1.7	0.6	3.2	14.7	12.1	13.7	0.34
****	Sundaram Large and Mid Cap	95.8	7222	1.5	0.7	11.7	16.1	13.2	14.7	0.36
****	Aditya Birla SL Large & Mid Cap	972.9	5827	1.6	0.9	7.3	12.9	9.3	11.0	0.20
****	Navi Large & Midcap	37.3	313	2.1	0.5	5.5	10.2	11.1	12.1	0.29
****	Tata Large & Mid Cap	502.7	7901	1.5	0.6	-4.3	7.5	9.9	11.8	0.28
EQUITY - FLEXI CAP FUNDS										
*****	HDFC Flexi Cap	2082.6	110736	1.1	0.6	3.5	16.9	18.6	15.5	0.61
*****	JM Flexicap	101.2	5185	1.6	0.6	3.1	15.4	16.4	15.6	0.46
*****	Parag Parikh Flexi Cap	82.8	148429	1.0	0.5	-2.2	13.7	12.6	16.4	0.44
*****	Aditya Birla SL Flexi Cap	1982.1	28112	1.4	0.7	10.0	16.5	12.8	13.4	0.36
*****	Edelweiss Flexi Cap	39.6	3613	1.6	0.5	3.8	14.9	13.1	14.1	0.35
*****	PGIM India Ind Flexi Cap	1619.4	19509	1.4	0.8	-1.5	12.6	13.2	12.8	0.37
*****	HSBC Flexi Cap	237.6	5718	1.6	0.9	8.0	16.9	14.1	12.7	0.35
****	Axis Flexi Cap	28.7	13478	1.5	0.7	6.2	14.7	9.7	-	0.24
****	Bandhan Flexi Cap	212.8	7575	1.5	0.9	0.8	12.3	10.9	10.6	0.30
****	Canara Robeco Flexi Cap	348.3	13615	1.5	0.5	0.7	12.4	10.4	13.6	0.29
****	DSP Flexi Cap	105.1	12422	1.5	0.6	2.8	12.3	10.5	13.2	0.27
****	Kotak Flexicap	86.2	56119	1.2	0.5	1.6	12.8	11.6	12.7	0.32
****	Navi Flexi Cap	25.3	290	2.1	0.5	11.4	11.5	11.4	-	0.31
****	PGIM India Flexi Cap	37.5	5898	1.6	0.5	1.8	10.8	8.3	13.2	0.20
****	Union Flexi Cap	53.2	2404	1.7	0.8	3.9	11.8	11.0	12.7	0.30
****	LIC MF Flexi Cap	109.1	1075	1.9	0.9	10.6	13.2	11.1	10.4	0.29
****	Motilal Oswal Flexi Cap	63.7	13940	1.4	0.7	3.0	20.4	12.8	12.5	0.32
****	SBI Flexicap	109.6	22897	1.4	0.7	0.4	9.3	9.0	11.3	0.23
****	Tata Flexi Cap	23.9	3705	1.6	0.6	-2.5	10.6	9.6	-	0.27
****	Shriram Flexi Cap	20.0	134	2.1	0.8	-1.2	7.8	7.9	-	0.17
****	Taurus Flexi Cap	237.7	369	2.1	2.0	5.6	12.6	11.3	9.6	0.30
****	UTI Flexi Cap	333.5	24036	1.4	0.8	1.5	9.8	6.2	11.7	0.12
****	Quant Flexi Cap	109.5	7262	1.5	0.6	14.9	16.0	15.6	18.4	0.39
EQUITY - MULTI CAP FUNDS										
****	Baroda BNP Paribas Multi Cap	301.0	3432	1.7	0.8	4.4	15.5	14.3	13.7	0.37
****	ICICI Pru Multicap	872.7	18769	1.4	0.8	9.3	17.4	16.1	14.3	0.48
****	Invesco India Multicap	133.5	4398	1.6	0.6	1.5	14.1	12.4	13.2	0.29
****	ITI Multi Cap	26.6	1468	1.8	0.5	12.6	17.7	14.2	-	0.34
****	Mahi Manu Multi Cap	39.9	7184	1.5	0.5	12.7	17.7	16.4	-	0.42
****	Nippon Ind Multi Cap	305.7	55587	1.2	0.6	0.8	14.5	18.6	15.0	0.56
****	Quant Multi Cap	661.3	7717	1.5	0.6	7.5	10.5	12.4	17.1	0.28
****	Sundaram Multi Cap	399.9	2981	1.7	0.8	4.2	14.3	13.3	14.2	0.36
EQUITY - MID CAP FUNDS										
*****	Edelweiss Mid Cap	110.6	18693	1.4	0.4	8.6	21.9	19.1	17.9	0.50
*****	Nippon Ind Growth Mid Cap	4575.5	50751	1.2	0.6	9.4	20.5	19.5	17.9	0.54
*****	Quant Mid Cap	221.2	8107	1.5	0.7	5.2	12.4	16.2	16.8	0.41
*****	HDFC Mid Cap	213.4	105143	1.1	0.6	9.7	19.2	20.6	17.0	0.61
*****	Invesco India Midcap	300.3	14721	1.5	0.5	8.7	24.4	20.4	18.2	0.51
*****	Mahi Manu Mid Cap	27.3	5186	1.6	0.5	12.9	20.2	18.7	-	0.49
*****	Motilal Oswal Midcap	105.6	40036	1.3	0.7	1.4	21.3	22.8	16.8	0.55
****	Baroda BNP Paribas Mid Cap	113.2	2584	1.7	0.5	11.6	17.7	15.4	14.8	0.43
****	HSBC Midcap	477.0	15578	1.4	0.5	21.3	25.1	19.3	17.0	0.46
****	ICICI Pru Midcap	348.7	7954	1.5	0.9	16.6	23.2	18.5	16.5	0.51
****	Kotak Midcap	147.7	69283	1.2	0.3	7.4	18.6	17.3	16.9	0.48
****	PGIM India Midcap	67.2	11071	1.5	0.5	1.0	12.3	11.4	15.1	0.30
****	SBI Midcap	244.0	24354	1.4	0.7	6.0	12.6	14.8	13.4	0.42
****	Sundaram Mid Cap	1527.8	14504	1.5	0.8	9.5	20.6	18.3	14.4	0.51
****	Tata Mid Cap	469.3	6056	1.6	0.5	8.5	15.7	15.5	15.7	0.44
****	Aditya Birla SL Midcap	868.5	6723	1.6	0.9	10.0	17.5	15.4	13.3	0.40
****	Axis Midcap	123.2	34404	1.3	0.5	7.4	17.3	15.8	16.5	0.38
****	Franklin Ind Mid Cap	2885.9	12871	1.5	0.8	4.3	17.7	15.2	13.9	0.39
****	UTI Mid Cap	321.5	12379	1.5	0.7	5.7	13.5	13.4	13.6	0.33
****	DSP Midcap	158.5	20523	1.4	0.6	6.8	15.9	12.7	13.9	0.32
****	LIC MF Midcap	31.7	376	2.1	1.2	9.0	17.8	14.1	-	0.34
****	Taurus Mid Cap	128.8	135	2.1	1.7	5.1	11.5	13.6	14.2	0.32
EQUITY - SMALL CAP FUNDS										
*****	Bank of India Small Cap	58.1	2819	1.7	0.4	26.3	22.5	20.1	-	0.44
*****	Quant Small Cap	289.2	34069	1.3	0.6	13.5	17.9	20.0	19.9	0.42
*****	Edelweiss Small Cap	48.7	6818	1.6	0.4	10.6	16.4	17.8	-	0.44

b.l. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr.)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				Sortino Ratio (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	10 Year CAGR	
*****	Invesco India Smallcap	48.5	14475	1.5	0.4	14.6	23.3	20.1	-	0.47
*****	Nippon Ind Small Cap	186.2	78957	1.1	0.5	9.9	16.8	20.1	20.6	0.48
*****	Union Small Cap	60.4	2402	1.7	0.8	22.3	18.5	18.0	16.5	0.40
****	AXIS Small Cap	118.1	30089	1.4	0.6	10.6	16.6	16.8	18.4	0.46
****	Canara Robeco Small Cap	41.6	14231	1.5	0.4	7.4	13.8	16.3	-	0.40
****	DSP Small Cap	232.1	20221	1.4	0.7	17.8	18.5	18.7	16.5	0.44
****	HSBC Small Cap	91.0	17784	1.4	0.6	12.3	15.5	18.5	17.9	0.40
****	Kotak Small Cap	278.2	18933	1.4	0.5	6.1	13.0	13.6	16.2	0.33
****	LIC MF Small Cap	35.1	758	2.0	0.8	17.5	19.1	18.7	-	0.42
****	Sundaram Small Cap	301.2	3922	1.6	0.7	17.0	18.3	17.6	14.6	0.41
****	Franklin Ind Small Cap	181.								

bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr.)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below
				Regular	Direct	1 Month %Ann	3 Month %Ann	6 Month %Ann	1 Year CAGR	

CASH FUNDS

LIQUID FUNDS

- 360 ONE Liquid	2149.4	573	0.3	0.2	6.0	6.3	6.3	6.1	-
- Aditya Birla SL Liquid	451.2	68800	0.3	0.2	6.3	6.8	6.7	6.4	-
- Axis Liquid	3119.1	56438	0.2	0.1	6.3	6.8	6.8	6.4	-
- Bandhan Liquid	3378.6	19031	0.2	0.1	6.1	6.6	6.6	6.3	-
- Bank of India Liquid	3225.3	1728	0.1	0.1	6.2	6.7	6.7	6.4	1.50
- Baroda BNP Paribas Liquid	3216.5	12206	0.2	0.1	6.2	6.7	6.6	6.3	1.20
- Canara Robeco Liquid	3369.2	6792	0.2	0.1	6.3	6.6	6.7	6.3	-
- DSP Liquidity	3998.0	22962	0.2	0.1	6.3	6.8	6.7	6.4	-
- Edelweiss Liquid	3581.8	13796	0.2	0.1	6.2	6.8	6.7	6.4	-
- Groww Liquid	2707.1	323	0.2	0.1	6.2	6.7	6.7	6.3	-
- HDFC Liquid	5491.3	65870	0.3	0.2	6.2	6.7	6.6	6.3	-
- HSBC Liquid	2790.4	20047	0.2	0.1	6.1	6.7	6.7	6.3	-
- ICICI Pru Liquid	414.3	61558	0.3	0.2	6.2	6.7	6.6	6.3	-
- Invesco India Liquid	3848.2	20723	0.2	0.1	6.2	6.8	6.7	6.4	-
- ITI Liquid	1454.2	48	0.2	0.1	5.9	6.1	6.3	6.0	-
- JM Liquid	76.3	2849	0.2	0.1	6.2	6.6	6.5	6.2	-
- Kotak Liquid	5656.0	51309	0.3	0.2	6.2	6.7	6.7	6.3	-
- LIC MF Liquid	5059.6	16809	0.2	0.1	6.2	6.7	6.7	6.3	-
- Mahi Manu Liquid	1821.5	1280	0.2	0.1	6.4	6.8	6.6	6.3	-
- Mirae Asset Liquid	2933.0	13190	0.2	0.1	6.2	6.6	6.5	6.3	-
- Motilal Oswal Liquid	14.7	966	0.4	0.2	5.6	6.3	6.1	5.9	-
- Navi Liquid	30.3	76	0.2	0.2	5.5	6.0	5.8	5.7	-
- Nippon Ind Liquid	6831.1	41346	0.3	0.2	6.2	6.8	6.7	6.3	-
- Parag Parikh Liquid	1551.8	7009	0.2	0.1	6.3	6.6	6.6	6.3	-
- PGIM India Liquid	364.5	787	0.2	0.1	6.2	6.8	6.7	6.4	1.90
- Quant Liquid	44.0	1603	0.5	0.3	5.7	6.1	5.8	5.8	-
- Quantum Liquid	37.3	537	0.2	0.1	5.9	6.1	5.9	5.8	-
- SBI Liquid	4374.1	84055	0.3	0.2	6.2	6.7	6.7	6.3	-
- Sundaram Liquid	2467.8	10633	0.3	0.1	6.0	6.9	6.7	6.3	-
- Tata Liquid	4408.2	27603	0.3	0.2	6.2	6.7	6.6	6.3	-
- TRUSTMF Liquid	1358.5	1130	0.2	0.1	6.1	6.6	6.5	6.2	-
- Union Liquid	2693.7	7564	0.2	0.1	6.3	6.7	6.6	6.4	-
- UTI Liquid	459.3	26728	0.2	0.1	6.2	6.7	6.7	6.4	-
- WhiteOak Capital Liquid	1503.8	672	0.2	0.1	6.3	6.7	6.6	6.2	-

OVERNIGHT FUNDS

- Aditya Birla SL Overnight	1472.9	9747	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.2	-
- Axis Overnight	1449.1	10178	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.2	5.2	5.3	-
- Bandhan Overnight	1453.6	1123	0.1	0.0	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.2	-
- Bank of India Overnight	1393.6	63	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.5	-
- Baroda BNP Paribas Overnight	1436.5	557	0.1	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- Canara Robeco Overnight	1416.8	444	0.1	0.1	5.2	5.2	5.1	5.3	-
- DSP Overnight	1463.0	3601	0.1	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.2	-
- Edelweiss Overnight	1415.9	120	0.1	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.2	-
- Franklin Ind Overnight	1428.6	926	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.2	5.2	5.3	-
- Groww Overnight	1405.7	27	0.2	0.1	4.8	4.9	5.0	5.1	-
- HDFC Overnight	4029.6	11145	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.2	-
- HSBC Overnight	1425.5	4766	0.1	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- ICICI Pru Overnight	1471.3	13144	0.1	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.2	-
- Invesco India Overnight	1383.2	591	0.1	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- ITI Overnight	1379.9	16	0.2	0.1	4.7	4.8	4.8	5.0	-
- JM Overnight	1385.2	99	0.1	0.1	4.7	4.9	4.9	5.1	-
- Kotak Overnight	1455.9	8818	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.2	-
- LIC MF Overnight	1412.4	662	0.1	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- Mahi Manu Overnight	1411.9	281	0.1	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.0	5.2	-
- Mirae Asset Overnight	1400.5	1562	0.1	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.2	-
- Nippon Ind Overnight	146.6	8376	0.1	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.2	-
- PGIM India Overnight	1409.7	167	0.2	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.0	5.2	-
- SBI Overnight	4406.7	29876	0.1	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.2	-
- Sundaram Overnight	1448.8	1896	0.1	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.2	-
- Tata Overnight	1438.6	5278	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.2	-
- Union Overnight	1435.9	613	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.2	-
- UTI Overnight	3718.7	5089	0.1	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.3	-

ARBITRAGE FUNDS

- Aditya Birla SL Arbitrage	28.4	26939	0.9	0.3	6.4	6.7	5.9	5.9	-
- Axis Arbitrage	20.0	10339	0.9	0.3	6.8	6.6	6.0	6.0	-
- Bandhan Arbitrage	34.6	8011	0.9	0.3	6.5	6.5	5.7	5.7	-
- Bank of India Arbitrage	14.7	136	0.9	0.4	7.2	5.7	5.5	5.6	-
- Baroda BNP Paribas Arbitrage	17.1	1125	1.0	0.3	6.3	6.0	5.5	5.6	-
- DSP Arbitrage	15.9	6646	0.9	0.3	6.6	6.6	5.8	5.9	-
- Edelweiss Arbitrage	20.7	15139	0.9	0.3	6.5	6.8	6.1	6.0	-
- HDFC Arbitrage	32.8	25001	0.8	0.3	6.8	6.9	6.1	6.1	-
- HSBC Arbitrage	20.3	2998	0.8	0.2	7.0	6.7	6.2	6.1	-
- ICICI Pru Arbitrage	36.7	34180	0.8	0.3	7.0	6.9	6.1	6.1	-
- Invesco India Arbitrage	34.1	29629	0.9	0.3	6.6	6.7	6.0	6.1	-
- ITI Arbitrage	13.8	71	0.8	0.2	5.9	5.2	5.4	5.7	-
- JM Arbitrage	34.7	391	0.9	0.4	6.8	6.1	5.6	5.8	-
- Kotak Arbitrage	40.1	74399	0.8	0.3	6.7	6.7	6.1	6.1	-
- LIC MF Arbitrage	14.7	265	0.7	0.2	5.8	6.4	5.9	5.9	-
- Mahi Manu Arbitrage	13.1	132	1.0	0.3	5.3	5.6	5.1	5.4	-
- Mirae Asset Arbitrage	13.9	3872	0.8	0.1	6.1	6.4	5.7	5.9	-
- Nippon Ind Arbitrage	28.4	16916	0.9	0.3	7.0	6.8	6.0	6.0	0.30
- PGIM India Arbitrage	19.5	83	0.9	0.3	5.4	5.8	5.8	5.7	-
- SBI Arbitrage Opport	36.2	46803	0.8	0.3	7.1	6.6	6.1	6.1	-
- Sundaram Arbitrage	15.4	553	0.8	0.2	6.0	6.3	6.0	6.0	-
- Tata Arbitrage	15.4	24725	0.9	0.3	6.3	6.5	5.9	5.9	-
- Union Arbitrage	15.0	226	0.9	0.3	8.0	7.1	6.2	6.0	-
- UTI Arbitrage	37.5	11152	0.7	0.2	7.0	6.7	6.0	6.1	-

bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr.)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	2 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	

DEBT FUNDS

DEBT - ULTRA SHORT DURATION FUNDS

***** Aditya Birla SL Savings	588.8	18189	0.5	0.3	6.2	7.1	7.2	6.5	9.68
***** Baroda BNPP Ultra Short Duration	1655.6	649	0.4	0.2	6.3	6.9	7.1	6.4	-
***** Mirae Asset Ultra Short Duration	1404.5	1916	0.4	0.2	6.3	7.0	7.1	6.4	12.70
***** Bandhan Ultra Short Duration	16.3	4205	0.4	0.2	6.2	6.8	7.0	6.2	-
***** HSBC Ultra Short Duration	1452.8	3322	0.3	0.1	6.3	6.9	7.0	6.2	-
***** ICICI Pru Ultra Short Term	29.7	15455	0.7	0.3	6.2	6.8	7.0	6.3	7.92
***** Nippon Ind Ultra Short Duration	4313.7	11659	0.9	0.3	6.1	6.7	6.8	6.1	22.83
*** Axis Ultra Short Duration	15.7	5908	1.1	0.3	5.8	6.4	6.6	5.8	8.50
*** DSP Ultra Short	3636.4	4456	0.9	0.3	5.8	6.5	6.6	5.8	6.81
*** HDFC Ultra Short Term	16.2	16678	0.6	0.3	6.0	6.7	6.9	6.1	8.57
*** Invesco India Ultra Short Duration	2887.2	1073	0.7	0.2	6.1	6.7	6.9	6.0	4.47
*** Kotak Savings	45.8	15708	0.7	0.3	5.9	6.6	6.7	6.0	6.00
*** Mahi Manu Ultra Short Duration	1473.3	205	0.6	0.3	6.1	6.7	6.9	6.1	1.22
*** SBI Ultra Short Duration	6400.7	11165	0.5	0.3	6.1	6.8	6.9	6.2	11.83
*** Tata Ultra Short Term	15.2	6378	1.0	0.3	6.0	6.5	6.6	5.8	8.62
*** UTI Ultra Short Duration	4528.4	3444	0.9	0.3	5.9	6.5	6.7	6.5	11.75
*** WhiteOak Capital Ultra Short Dur	1451.8	552	0.7	0.3	5.7	6.3	6.4	5.8	-
** BOI Ultra Short Duration	3375.2	168	0.9	0.4	5.8	6.4	6.4	5.7	6.56
** Canara Robeco Ultra Short Term	4053.8	58	0.8	0.3	5.8	6.4	6.4	5.6	-
** LIC MF Ultra Short Duration	1409.0	509	1.2	0.2	5.7	6.3	6.4	5.7	1.00
** PGIM India Ultra Short Duration	36.3	176	0.8	0.3	5.5	6.2	6.4	5.7	2.84
* ITI Ultra Short Term	1316.6	163	0.8	0.2	5.6	6.1	6.3	5.5	-
* Motilal Oswal Ultra Short Term	17.5	515	1.0	0.2	5.2	5.5	5.7	5.0	-
* Sundaram Ultra Short Duration	2847.7	2284	1.3	0.2	5.2	5.8	6.0	5.3	1.36

DEBT - LOW DURATION FUNDS

***** ICICI Pru Savings	584.4	21735	0.5	0.4	6.3	7.2	7.4	6.6	6.69
***** UTI Low Duration	3804.4	2386	0.4	0.3	6.1	7.1	7.2	7.4	8.01
***** Axis Treasury Advantage	3314.6	4637	0.6	0.3	6.0	7.0	7.1	6.3	7.07
***** Bandhan Low Duration	41.2	6583	0.6	0.3	5.8	6.7	6.9	6.0	-
***** HDFC Low Duration	61.6	18420	0.9	0.4	5.6	6.7	6.8	6.1	11.33

bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest	Latest	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA
		NAV (₹)	Corpus (₹ Cr)	Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	2 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	& Below
*****	HSBC Low Duration	30.7	994	0.8	0.3	5.9	7.5	7.4	6.4	6.70
*****	Aditya Birla SL Low Duration	698.5	9914	1.0	0.4	5.3	6.4	6.6	5.9	11.21
*****	Canara Robeco Savings	45.1	1086	0.4	0.2	5.9	6.8	6.9	6.1	-
*****	DSP Low Duration	21.2	4478	0.5	0.3	5.7	6.7	6.8	6.0	-
*****	Invesco India Low Duration	4042.2	1640	0.5	0.3	5.7	6.7	6.9	6.0	9.52
*****	JM Low Duration	39.6	217	0.8	0.3	5.7	6.7	6.8	6.0	3.44
*****	Mirae Asset Low Duration	2410.8	2044	0.7	0.2	5.7	6.6	6.8	5.9	7.34
*****	Nippon Ind Low Duration	4000.2	7804	0.8	0.3	5.8	6.8	6.9	6.1	7.56
*****	Tata Treasury Advantage	4207.3	2240	0.5	0.2	6.0	6.8	6.9	6.1	6.52
****	Kotak Low Duration	3564.2	12083	1.0	0.4	5.5	6.6	6.7	5.9	8.78
****	LIC MF Low Duration	42.2	1748	0.4	0.2	5.8	6.6	6.7	5.8	5.95
****	Mahi Manu Low Duration	1743.9	541	0.9	0.3	5.6	6.5	6.7	5.8	13.64
****	SBI Low Duration	3719.5	13102	0.8	0.4	5.4	6.5	6.7	5.9	4.10
***	Baroda BNP Paribas Low Duration	42.7	391	0.9	0.2	5.6	6.5	6.6	5.8	-
***	Sundaram Low Duration	3676.6	433	1.0	0.3	5.2	6.4	6.5	5.8	2.24

Drugs Controller flags regulatory risks as pharma industry races to embrace AI

ACCOUNTABILITY. What happens when AI begins making recommendations directly to consumers, wondered Rajeev Raghuvanshi

Avinash Nair
Ahmedabad

When Drugs Controller General of India (DCGI) Rajeev Raghuvanshi walked through the stalls at the third edition of the IIMA Healthcare Summit in Ahmedabad on Saturday, one exhibit stopped him in his tracks. It was a stall advertising an “AI Doctor”.

For the country’s top drug regulator, the proposition was less futuristic and more “frightening”. “AI is helping in multiple ways. But the issues as a regulator today are sometimes too frightening to me — the way I see it moving. Today, whether AI fits into the definition of medical devices is not known to many people,” said Raghuvanshi as he narrated his experience of the stall-walk through at the summit with the theme, “Advancing AI in Healthcare.”

His concern was not about whether AI would enter healthcare. The harder question is what happens when AI begins moving from being a tool used by doctors and drug developers, to making recommendations directly to consumers.

ACCOUNTABILITY ISSUE

In conventional medicine, he pointed out, “In drugs there is a prescription system where the doctor writes a prescription and so there is accountability of the doctor. If a mobile application is dictating what to take, where is that accountability and then there is no end to it.”

The DCGI said regulators approve a product based on defined characteristics of quality, safety and performance and expect those characteristics to remain consistent through the product’s lifecycle. Regulators are trained



EFFICIENT PRACTICE. According to Patel, an AI scribe can prepare a clinical note while a doctor listens to the patient

to pull a product back to the quality and performance that was approved 10 or 20 years ago. If a company wants to make a significant improvement, it generally has to return to the regulator with a new application.

“It (AI) actually changes on a daily basis,” Raghuvanshi said. “So, we are also learning and trying to see how to regulate a moving target,” the official added.

Despite the regulator’s

fears, AI is already finding a place across the pharmaceutical value chain, particularly among companies involved in research and discovery.

CUTTING TIMELINES

Raghuvanshi estimates that its adoption remains concentrated among perhaps the top 10 per cent of pharmaceutical companies, but for those engaged in discovery research, AI is increasingly becoming an everyday tool.

“Secondly, a lot of AI is being used in the generic industry to develop algorithms for analysing the data. The real advantage of AI is seen in cutting the timelines and success rates of clinical trials,” he added.

For pharma veteran Pankaj Patel, chairman of Zydus Lifesciences and chairman of the IIMA Board of Governors, this is beginning to change the economics of an industry that has historically depended heavily on patience, probability and failure. The traditional model involves screening enormous libraries of molecules, most of which fail, over a development cycle that can stretch beyond a decade and cost billions.

“We are not yet at a point where a machine-designed medicine will happen on its own,” Patel said. But research teams equipped with these tools can increasingly accom-

plish in months what once took years.

According to Patel, an AI scribe can prepare a clinical note while a doctor listens to the patient. An AI screening tool can analyse a chest X-ray or retinal scan in a district hospital where a radiologist or specialist may not be available. None of these applications, Patel argued, necessarily looks like a revolution in isolation.

“The most valuable thing that AI does is not to diagnose the disease. It is to hand back time to the doctor,” Patel said.

Abbott India’s Executive Vice President Vivek Mohan puts the same argument in terms of trust. The success of AI in healthcare, he said, will be built around how it is deployed, adopted and trusted, with its primary role being to support clinicians in decision-making rather than replace them.

India Pharma Archives, chronicling industry’s 125-year journey, launched

Our Bureau
Ahmedabad

The Indian Institute of Ahmedabad Archives and the Indian Pharmaceutical Alliance on Saturday launched *India Pharma Archives*, a dedicated digital repository documenting the 125-year evolution of India’s pharmaceutical industry.

Union Minister of State for Health and Family Welfare Anupriya Patel launched the publicly accessible archive at the IIM-A Healthcare Summit in Ahmedabad on Saturday.

The platform brings together company histories, archival documents, rare films and footages, as also timelines and interviews covering the people and institutions that shaped India’s pharmaceutical industry.

A key feature of the *Archive* is its collection of oral histories of first-genera-

tion pharma founders, capturing their experiences of building companies and navigating the science, entrepreneurship and policy environment that helped turn India into the pharmacy for the world.

TRIP DOWN HISTORY

The *Archive* currently spans 1901-2025, with more than 250 video stories, interviews with over 30 industry leaders, and nearly 1,000 documents and resources.

Sharvil Patel, MD, Zydus Lifesciences and President of IPA, stated that the *Archive* would celebrate the industry’s “collective journey” while creating a platform for new ideas, collaborations and solutions to future healthcare challenges.

The initiative builds on *The Alchemy of Cure*, a coffee-table book released earlier this year, and seeks to preserve the institutional memory of the industry.

BRICS science meet to build future-ready tech framework



Minister of State Jitendra Singh (centre) and others during the BRICS Science Ministerial Meet, in Chennai

Our Bureau
Chennai

The 14th BRICS Science Ministerial Meet chaired by India in Chennai on Saturday adopted a Declaration reaffirming BRICS commitment to build effective, resilient and future-ready framework in science, technology and innovation (STI).

The Chennai Consensus, adopted under India’s BRICS Chairmanship, places a “people-centred and humanity-first approach at the heart of STI cooperation, with emphasis on sustainable development, resilient and high-quality growth, social inclusiveness and the use of innovation and technology to improve the welfare and quality of life of people across BRICS nations.

In the closing session of the Meet, Union Minister of State (Independent Charge) for Science and Technology and Earth Sciences Jitendra Singh said that the breadth of discussions, from artificial intelligence and high-performance computing to quantum technologies, advanced materials, biotechno-

logy, health, climate and sustainability, reflect the shared opportunities and challenges that BRICS countries can address through collective action.

CREATE ACCESS

The Chennai Consensus records the growing maturity and depth of BRICS STI co-operation, with sustained activity across 14 thematic Working Groups, 11 editions of the BRICS Young Scientist Forum, nine editions of the Young Innovators Prize and nine BRICS STI Framework Programme calls.

The Declaration further welcomed the BRICS Youth Startup Platform, while recognising the need to catalyse financing for early- and growth-stage start-ups and recording the consideration of a BRICS Startup Innovation Fund in the BRICS Industry Ministers’ Declaration.

The Action Plan also provides a framework for greater access to research infrastructure, joint research and capacity building, including through the BRICS Global Research Advanced Infrastructure Network.

Press clubs should play a proactive role in restoring public trust in the media: N Ram

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

Press clubs across the country should play a proactive role in restoring public trust in the media, according to eminent journalist and Director of The Hindu Group, N Ram.

Speaking at the National Conclave of the Federation of Press Clubs here on Saturday, Ram said an erosion of public trust in the media and growing threats to its freedom and independence were two interconnected challenges confronting journalism.

Though political propaganda, misinformation and disinformation on social media led to the trust deficit largely, some sections of the media had also contributed to it through sensationalism, inadequate verification, communal rhetoric, invisible or reluctant corrections and excessive proximity to political and corporate interests, he said.

“When journalism becomes indistinguishable from political propaganda and when television debates substitute noise for information, public trust inevitably suffers,” Ram said.

According to him, a free press cannot survive on



Telangana Deputy CM Mallu Bhatti Vikramarka and The Hindu Group Director N Ram at the launch of the Federation of Press Clubs logo at the Federation’s first national conclave in Hyderabad. Also seen are Press Club of India President Sangeeta Barooah Pisharoty; Ananth Nath, Editor, Caravan; Federation Chairman Gautam Lahiri, and Telangana Media Academy Chairman K Srinivas Reddy. NAGARA GOPAL

constitutional and legal safeguards alone and public trust is equally crucial to its remaining an effective democratic institution.

THREAT TO MEDIA

On threat to media freedom, he said coercive tactics against journalists were not confined to any one political party or government. State governments of different political affiliations had also resorted to measures such as criminal cases, police action and attempts to arrest journalists.

The Federation of Press Clubs in India could establish a national network capable of responding quickly whenever journalists faced threats anywhere in the country, he

said. Senior advocate and former Union Minister Kapil Sibal had offered to provide *pro bono* services, leadership and financial support if an independent foundation was established for the legal protection of journalists, Ram said.

Press clubs had an important role in rebuilding that trust by promoting professional ethics and independence, Ram added.

ROLE IN DEMOCRACY

Telangana Deputy Chief Minister Mallu Bhatti Vikramarka called for a strong and independent media, saying journalism’s role in a democracy is to make those in power “explain itself” and hold authority to account.

“Governments and journalists were not expected to agree all the time, and if they did, citizens should perhaps start worrying,” he said adding publications such as *Amrita Bazar Patrika* and *The Hindu* had also helped shape public opinion during the Colonial period and the media should not stop at reporting events but should also examine what those events meant for society.

Ananth Nath, Editor, *Caravan*, and Sangeeta Barooah Pisharoty, President, Press Club of India, said a collective voice against attacks on journalistic freedom and journalists, would go a long way in strengthening desire for fair journalism and the affected parties.

Rain deficit inches up, but fresh Bay ‘low’ offers hope

Vinson Kurian
Thiruvananthapuram

The monsoon is showing little inclination to loosen its grip on the country’s eastern and central belts, with the India Meteorological Department (IMD) extending a watch for a fresh low-pressure area that could take shape as early as Sunday over the waters off the West Bengal-Bangladesh coasts.

This is even as rainfall figures for August, normally the second rainiest month, until Friday have been on the lower side, under the larger El Nino impact. The country as a whole has run up a rain deficit of 15.2 per cent, with South Peninsula logging the worst at 23.1 per cent, followed by Central India (16.5 per cent); East and North-East India (13.5 per cent); and North-West India (9.7 per cent). Overall figures for the season as a whole (June to August) are not inspiring either, with the all-India deficit inching up to 13.2 per cent. The new

‘low’ comes even as its predecessor continued to linger over north-east Madhya Pradesh on Saturday afternoon. The Bay’s weather pulse is expected to keep beating through the coming week and possibly right up to the end of August, numerical weather models suggest.

The Bay is, in effect, catching the rhythm of neighbouring South China Sea/West Pacific, where a succession of tropical systems has been spinning up.

SATELLITE IMAGERY

Satellite imagery on Saturday morning showed a cluster of cyclonic circulations scattered across and around the Bay, providing several potential seeds for the next weather system. By afternoon, circulations over the west-central and adjoining north-west Bay and the north Andhra Pradesh-south Odisha coasts merged with another over the north Bay and adjoining Bangladesh.

Two other circulations, one over south West Bengal

and adjoining Jharkhand and the other over south-west Madhya Pradesh had meanwhile weakened and disappeared.

The monsoon trough stretched from Amritsar through Najibabad, Hardoi and the centre of the existing low over north-east Madhya Pradesh, then across Jamshedpur and Digha before dipping into the north-east Bay.

SPILOVER BENEFITS

The emerging low’s projected track points to a fresh spell of rain over East and North-East India, with spillover benefits for parts of North-West and Central India. Some pockets of the southern peninsula could also get a share of the bounty.

The weekend and the opening days of next week are likely to maintain the familiar monsoon choreography, with East and North-East India remaining in the rain zone, alongside parts of North-West India, the West Coast and pockets of the Southern Peninsula.

Uniflow eyes 5-fold control-valve capacity as India looks to cut imports

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

Mumbai-based Uniflow Controls is investing ₹50 crore (\$5 million) to expand annual control-valve capacity more than five-fold, from 8,000 to 40,000–50,000 units, as refiners, petrochemical producers, LNG operators and power companies step up capital spending and seek greater domestic availability of critical equipment. The company’s new Industry 4.0-compliant manufacturing facility at Ambernath near Mumbai will mark the entry into LNG and nuclear energy applications.

An estimated 35–40 per cent of critical severe-service control valves are imported and can take 26–40 weeks to procure, creating a potential bottleneck as India adds refining, petrochemical, power capacity and builds capabilities in nuclear energy.

These high-pressure, cryogenic, anti-cavitation and corrosion-resistant valves regulate the flow, pressure and temperature of liquids and gases — the largely unseen equipment that keeps refineries, chemical plants, LNG facilities, power stations and pharmaceutical factories running.

“The objective is not simply to add production capacity, but to build a future-ready manufacturing ecosystem that combines automation, engineering capabilities and operational flexi-



Manoj Mishra, Managing Director, Uniflow

ility,” said Managing Director Manoj Mishra. The investment, Mishra said, would help Uniflow strengthen its domestic position, expand into LNG and nuclear energy and build capabilities to serve global markets.

The Ambernath plant will use CNC machinery, Industrial Internet of Things systems, AI-enabled predictive maintenance, computer-vision inspection and automated inventory and storage systems. Flexible manufacturing will also enable faster prototyping and production of customised valves.

The technology is important because substituting high-end imports isn’t simply about producing more units. Severe-service valves must withstand extreme pressures and temperatures, handle cryogenic or corrosive fluids and meet stringent safety and reliability requirements, which Uniflow plans to specialise

Centre amends Cable TV Rules, removing the 12-minute ad cap

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

The Centre has now officially notified the amendments to the Cable TV Network Rules removing the 12-minute ad duration cap for television channels. Earlier the Information and Broadcasting Ministry had said this decision was taken to ensure a level playing field, fair competition and ease of doing business.

Analysts said this is directionally positive for television broadcasters, providing greater flexibility to monetise inventory and to some extent address the regulatory disadvantage compared to digital platforms.

The official notification from the Ministry said, “In the Cable Television Networks Rules, 1994, in Rule 7, sub-rule (11) shall be omitted,” which refers to the amendment that capped television advertisements at 12 minutes per clock hour. The advertisement duration cap for television channels was introduced in 2006.

“In view of the changes that have occurred in the TV broadcasting sector, a need was felt to revisit the stipulations re-

lating to advertisement duration.

Furthermore, there was a non-level playing field for traditional TV channels *vis-à-vis* digital media, where no such stipulation on advertisement cap regulation exists,” the Ministry said in its statement earlier.

Elara Capital, in a report, noted that this move is “directionally positive” and could lead to a revenue benefit in the range of 1–3 per cent.

“Most of the industry already operates at or above the cap, with news channels carrying 16–18 minutes/hour, while live sports offers limited scope to additional inventory. Fundamentally, television’s key challenges relate to declining viewership and content engagement,” Karan Taurani, EVP, Elara Capital, stated in the report.

businessline.

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